ExoVista v2.6 User Guide

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1. Summary

ExoVista 2 is a hybrid Python/C++ software package based on an earlier IDL/C iteration that generates synthetic exoplanetary systems. ExoVista models exoplanet atmospheres in reflected light, stellar spectra using the Phoenix stellar spectra models, and debris disks in scattered light using realistic spatial distributions and optical properties. Planets can be drawn from measured/extrapolated *Kepler* occurrence rates (Dulz et al. 2020) and are checked for basic stability criteria; debris disks are dynamically quasi-self-consistent with the underlying planetary system. All bodies are integrated with a Bulirsch-Stoer integrator to determine their barycentric velocities, positions, and orbits. And the orbits are checked for transits and secondary eclipses at low (0.01 d) temporal resolution. The output product is a multi-extension FITS file that contains all of the information necessary to generate a spectral data cube of the system for direct imaging simulations of coronagraphs/starshades, as well as position/velocity data for simulation of RV and astrometric data sets, and transit and eclipse times. It is also possible to feed the output back in as input for iterative purposes. A more detailed description of the scientific model used by ExoVista is given in Appendix B.

2. Philosophy & Numerical Approach

ExoVista was designed with two primary numerical goals. First, it was designed for speed, to rapidly generate randomized planetary systems for a large number of stars/scenarios. To enable this, only simple checks are performed for dynamic stability of the planetary systems, and analytic models are used for the debris disks. Second, ExoVista's output file size was minimized, such that all required information on the planetary system is contained in $\lesssim$25 MB. (The file size is determined primarily by the spectral resolution of the disk and the baseline of orbit integration, and file sizes will be smaller for many applications.) To minimize file size, ExoVista does not save a simple spectral image cube. Instead, the output is a list of each point source's position, velocity, orbit, and contrast/flux spectrum. This is combined with a contrast data cube of the debris disk, which has a smooth wavelength dependence and can be saved at lower spectral resolution. Transit and eclipse times are saved separately. As a consequence of recording disk contrast instead of disk flux, ExoVista cannot include thermal emission from the disk. We have provided a Python class (`Scene.py`) that loads the output FITS files to aid in extracting particular data sets from them. The various "`readfits`" scripts include several default applications of this class, particularly for visualizations.

3. Installation and Use Cases

ExoVista is designed to generate a universe of planetary systems based on varying assumptions about the overall exoplanet population. This use case requires familiarity with the complete ExoVista code and moderate to large computing facilities. Most of this guide is designed to provide a detailed description of ExoVista, its modules, and its dependencies for this use case. Additionally, a full API for ExoVista is provided in Appendix B.

Many users will likely wish to interact only with the data products of ExoVista, using existing simulations of planetary systems to simulate direct imaging instruments, or for planet detection simulations. These users should download the existing FITS planetary scene files from https://tools.emac.gsfc.nasa.gov/exovista/ which can be read by any FITS tool such as astropy. *Note: these files do not include transit detection.*

An example of an up-to-date output file (for our Solar system) is also provided in the "`output`" subdirectory.

Users may also wish to generate a single planetary system based on the specific properties of a known system, either our own Solar system or an already-known exoplanet system. For this use case, the "`read_solarsystem`" function is used to read in an input file that specifies the properties of each system component. The "`solar_system.dat`" and "`solar_system_tutorial.dat`" files are provided as an example of this input format.

A detailed description of the FITS files produced by ExoVista is provided in Section 7. The included "`Scene.py`" also provides pre-programmed options for reading the FITS files. Meanwhile, the "`parsefits.py`" routine takes an output file for a single system and generates a new, matching input file. This can be useful for recomputing randomly-generated planetary systems with iterative changes.

To run the main modules of ExoVista, you must have a Python interpreter (**Python 3.8 or higher** recommended). You will also need to have installed, in addition to the "standard" suite of Python modules, the Python packages **scipy, astropy, cython,** and **PIL**. The **multiprocessing** package is needed if you wish to use ExoVista with parallel processing, although ExoVista can run as a serial code without it. The "`readfits-anim.py`" visualizer script requires the **ffmpeg** package and the separate FFmpeg software. If these are not available, the "`readfits-flipbook.py`" script can be used to output individual frames to the screen.

ExoVista also requires a **C++ compiler**:
For Linux users, `g++` is usually available.
For Mac OS users, it is recommended to install Apple's XCode to obtain a compiler.
For Windows users, it is recommended to use the Microsoft Visual C/C++ compiler.
Other tools such as those found in MinGW or Cygwin may work, but these have not been tested.

To install ExoVista:

Download the current version of the ExoVista package from the Github repository into the desired directory on your local machine. Open a terminal window, navigate to the "`ExoVista`" directory, and install the package with `pip`:

```
pip install .
```

If you do not have `pip` installed directly, you may be able to install the package through Python:

```
python -m pip install .
```

As part of the installation process, Cython should automatically call your C++ compiler and generate the files "`wrapImage.cpp`" and "`wrapIntegrator.cpp`" on your machine in the "`src/exovista`" subdirectory. Once the `wrapImage` and `wrapIntegrator` modules are built successfully, you will be ready to run all ExoVista modules.

If you make changes to the source code or data files in the "`src/exovista`" directory, you will need to reinstall the package with `pip` to implement them.

This installation does not include the stellar spectrum database, because of the size of the required files. These must be downloaded separately.

The standard stellar spectrum files used by ExoVista can be downloaded at the following link:

https://phoenix.astro.physik.uni-goettingen.de/data/MedResFITS/R10000FITS/PHOENIX-ACES-AGSS-COND-2011_R10000FITS_Z-0.0.zip

This file should be downloaded and unzipped in the **parent directory to your ExoVista work directory**. This allows the stellar spectrum files to be swapped out without disrupting the ExoVista package itself. If you want to use a different set of stellar spectra, you will need to change the file path in "`make_starmap.py.`"

Note for Windows users: When installing ExoVista for the first time, it may take a long time due to security scans slowing the copying of the .lqq files. Temporarily disabling these scans in Windows Defender, Norton 360, etc. may speed up this process. (But attempt at your own risk.)

4. Running

As packaged, the head "ExoVista" directory for the ExoVista package is intended to be the work directory. As installed, it should run anywhere in your system, but you may need to change the file paths for the stellar spectrum library and the output directory.

ExoVista can be run from the Python command line, but we recommend using a wrapper script to make full use of its features. This is especially important for larger target lists that require parallel processing. You may write your own wrapper based on the API described in Appendix B or modify the provided "ExoVista.py" and "ExoVistaSystem.py" scripts in the head directory.

ExoVista has two main modes of operation for its primary use case of generating simulated exoplanetary systems:

1. Generate a single, user-defined planetary system to simulate observations of known planets. An example is provided in ExoVistaSystem.py.
2. Create a universe of stochastically-generated simulated planetary systems based on a list of target stars and their properties. An example is provided in ExoVista.py.

4.1 Generating a Single, User-Defined System

"ExoVistaSystem.py" provides an example of how to create a user-defined planetary system. Most of the machinery in this script is designed to prompt for and check the format of an input file and should not be touched.

ExoVistaSystem.py can be run with an input file name as a command line argument, but it will prompt for one if it is not given, or if the requested file fails. The input file should define all aspects of the planetary system, and the format for this file is described in Section 5.1. The provided "solar_system.dat" input file defines our own Solar system.

The core functionality of the script is as follows: first, create a Settings object with the desired model parameters. Syntax:

```
Settings.Settings(<optional arguments>)
```

Next, call the read_solarsystem() function with the Settings object and an input file name as an argument. Syntax:

```
read_solarsystem.read_solarsystem(settings,system_file=filename)
```

The read_solarsystem() function converts the input file into the data structures used by ExoVista. The function outputs five new data structures (here described as s,p,a,d,c) plus an

amended `Settings` object (which may have changed in response to the input file, here described as `new_settings`), which are used as inputs for `generate_scene()`.

Next, call the `generate_starspots()` function with the `s` (star) data structure and the amended `Settings` object. (This step must be done separately for backwards compatibility reasons.) Syntax:

```
generate_starpots.generate_starspots(s,new_settings)
```

The `generate_starspots()` function creates the data structure for starspots (here described as `sp`) based on the parameters given in the input file.

Next, call the `generate_scene()` function to produce observations of the system over time. Syntax:

```
generate_scene.generate_scene(s,sp,p,a,d,c,new_settings)
```

The `generate_scene()` function is the main output function for ExoVista. It generates a FITS file for each planetary system in the data structure, which includes a spectral data cube for the exozodiacal disk, time-dependent spectra and orbital parameters for the star and each planet, and a list of transit and eclipse times. The output FITS format is described in Section 8. This FITS file may be used to model simulated observations as desired.

The optional arguments used be the `Settings` constructor are listed in Appendix B.12. Notable parameters for ExoVista users are:

- **`pixscale`**: the pixel size of the image in arcseconds. Default is 0.002.
- **`iwa`**: inner working angle of the coronagraph in arcseconds. Default is 0.015.
- **`specres`**: the resolution of the star and planet spectra. Default is R=300.
- **`specresdisk`**: the spectral resolution of the disk contrast cube. Default is R=10.
- **`lambdamin`** and **`lambdamax`**: the minimum and maximum wavelengths of the spectra, respectively, in microns. Defaults are 0.3 and 1.0.
  Warning*: the code will extrapolate beyond the ends of the stellar and planetary spectra using a constant function, which will produce incorrect results if the limits are set too wide. The wavelength limits of the recommended Phoenix models are 0.3 to 10.0 microns.*
- **`imin`** and **`imax`**: the minimum and maximum orbital inclination of the planets, in degrees. Default is 0.0 for both.
  Note*: a near-zero inclination may cause numerical instability in the longitude of ascending node and argument of periastron, but the more important longitude of periastron should remain stable.*
- **`timemax`**: the length of time to integrate the orbits of the planets, in years. Default is 1.e-10. Typical values for a survey are 5-10.
- **`dt`**: the time step at which to report the planetary positions and spectra, in years. Default is 10/365.25 (10 days).

- **`output_dir`**: the (relative) directory where the FITS files will be output. Default is "`output`."
- **`ncomponents`**: the number of components in the disk.
  ***Warning**: this must be equal to the number of disk components in the input file for the debris disk to be handled correctly. This is handled automatically in `ExoVistaSystem.py`.*
- **`randphase`**: if `True`, the Lambertian phase function for non-phase-resolved planetary albedos will be scaled by a randomized parameter based on the spread of phase functions in Solar system objects in Sudarsky et al. (2005). Default is `False`.
- **`randrad`**: if `True`, a random spread will be added to the mass-radius relation used to generate planets, based on the "fractional dispersion" hyperparameters in the model of Chen & Kipping (2017). Radii are limited to be <14.31 R_E for planets with periods of >10 days (scaled with stellar luminosity). Default is `False`.
  ***Warning**: this parameter is not compatible with the "`usebins`" parameter described in Section 4.2.*
- **`hires`**: if `True`, the disk spectral cube will be computed at the same resolution as the star and planetary spectra. This will use much more memory, but may be useful for generating emission and absorption disk spectra in future releases. It is recommended to use this option only with single-system input files. Default is `False`.

4.2 Generating a Universe of Randomized Planetary Systems from a Target List

"ExoVista.py" provides an example of how to generate a universe of planetary systems from a list of target stars. Most of the machinery in this script is used to set up Python's multiprocessing functions and should not be touched.

The input file for this script is the stellar target list, which must define all required parameters for the stars used by ExoVista. The format for this file is described in Section 5.3. The provided "master_target_list-usingDR2-50_pc.txt" input file includes a master list of roughly 8,000 target stars within 50 pc of Earth from the LUVOIR/HabEx design studies. We also provide a short target list of 8 stars called "target_list8.txt" for testing purposes.

The notable features of this script (all hard-coded) for ExoVista users are:

- **parallel**: if True, Python will distribute the stars evenly to all available cores on the system to speed the calculations in generate_scene(). Defaults to False if the "multiprocessing" module is not available.
- **maxcores**: allows the user to set a maximum number of cores to be used instead of using all available cores.
- **Settings**: as with the single-system script, this is an object that contains the settable code parameters. It is used as an argument by the generate_planets(), generate_disks(), and generate_scene() functions.
- **target_list_file**: the target list used by ExoVista to generate planetary systems. This is the main input file for ExoVista, the format of which is described in Section 5.3.
- **load_stars()**, **generate_planets()**, and **generate_disks()**: these three functions serve the same purpose as the read_solarsystem() function for a single system, generating the data structures used by the code to generate the scenes. These functions include optional arguments to change the configuration of the planetary systems, which are described in depth in the ExoVista API in Appendix B.
- **generate_starspots():** as in the ExoVistaSystem.py script, this function generates starspots for the target stars as a separate step.
- **addearth:** if True, generate_planets() will add an extra Earth twin (except with zero eccentricity) to every planetary system (orbit scaled with stellar luminosity) with negligible mass so as not to disrupt stability or orbit integration. This can be useful if, for example, you wish to calculate exposure times based on the detectability of an Earth twin. Default is False.
- **usebins:** if True, generate_planets()will use the rbound and abound arrays found in defaults.py to define bins based on planet types, and will ensure that exactly the expected number of planets of each type occur in each bin (subject to rounding). Default is False.
  ***Warning**: this feature is compatible with the randomized radii generated if the randrad flag is set to True.*

4.3 Post-Processing Routines

We have included several post-processing scripts in the ExoVista package. All of these scripts are backwards-compatible with earlier versions of the code, at least in that they will run successfully, although functionality may be limited.
***Note**: all of these scripts will ignore the "extra" Earth twin in the FITS file if it is present.*

"`parsefits.py`" is a script that reads an output FITS file and generates a new, matching single-system input file, which can be used to replicate the (possibly randomized) scene described by the output file exactly. This will be useful for recomputing a scene for a given system with different parameters, especially for the (planned) disk absorption/emission spectrum upgrade. `parsefits.py` is run directly from the command line, and it accepts up to two command line arguments for the file to be read and the directory to search:

- **`-f`** or **`-file <filename>`**: the FITS file to be read. Default behavior is to list them as a menu.
- **`-o`** or **`-output <dir_name>`**: the directory of FITS files that is to be enumerated for the menu prompt or searched for the input file. Default is "`./output`."

If no valid FITS file is given on the command line, `parsefits.py` will produce a numbered list of the FITS files in the default (or specified) output directory and prompt the user for a file number.

"`Scene.py`" is a module containing the `Scene` class, which can process an ExoVista output FITS file into useful `NumPy` arrays and output system properties and data with utility functions. A `Scene` object is instantiated with an input file name using the syntax:

```
scene = Scene.Scene(inputfile)
```

Data can be retrieved from the FITS file using the provided utility functions. The full list of functions is described in Appendix B.14. They follow the general format of:

```
data = scene.get<parameter>(time)
```

"`add_background.py`" is a module that generates a random data cube of extragalactic background sources for a given scene based on the Haystacks model found at https://asd.gsfc.nasa.gov/projects/haystacks/downloads.html
This module requires you to download Extragalactic background cubes 0 through 5 (this may change if you change the wavelength coverage of the scenes) from the Haystacks webpage. It is called with an input file and optionally a time (in years) with the syntax:

```
add_background.add_background(inputfile, time=0)
```

This function returns a data cube of extragalactic fluxes with the same format as the disk data cube.

***Note**: this module is still in active development, with plans to add background stars, target parallax, and proper motion, and the current version has not been thoroughly tested.*

"`readfits.py`" is a plotting script that produces five plots of interest for a specified FITS file and prints the transit and eclipse times listed in the file. Similar to `parsefits.py`, `readfits.py` may be run directly from the command line. If it is run without specifying a file name, it will produce a numbered list of FITS files in the default output directory and prompt you to choose a file.

`readfits.py` may be run with command line arguments, which control the file selected as well as various aspects of the plotting. These available command line arguments are:

- **`-l`** or **`-lambda <wavelength>`**: reference wavelength in microns. The disk and planet fluxes will each be plotted at the closest wavelength point to this value. Default is 0.5.
- **`-m`** or **`-mirror <diameter>`**: the size of the telescope mirror circumscribed diameter in meters. Default is 8.0 (based on the LUVOIR-B concept).
- **`-g`** or **`-gain <factor>`**: the brightness of the disk will be multiplied by this value to highlight faint regions, at the cost of saturating bright regions. Default is 1.0.
- **`-ld`** or **`-logdisk`**: if included, the disk brightness will be plotted based on a logarithmic scale rather than a linear one. Default is `False`.
- **`-pb`** or **`-planetbright`**: if included, the brightness of each planet will be scaled relative to the maximum of its own phase curve. Default is `False`.
- **`-c`** or **`-color`**: if included, the planets will be color-coded based on type. (The colors are hard-coded at the top of the `readfits.py` script.) Default is `False`.
- **`-f`** or **`-file <filename>`**: the FITS file to be read. Default behavior is to list them as a menu.
- **`-o`** or **`-output <dir_name>`**: the directory of FITS files that is to be enumerated for the menu prompt or searched for the input file. Default is "`./output`."

The plots produced by `readfits.py` are:

- An ideal simulated image of the scene in the 250x250 pixel frame at t=0. Disk contrast is indicated by relative brightness, with the region within 1.5λ/D of the star blacked out by an occulting disk, similar to a coronograph simulation.
- A plot of disk contrast versus position also the x-axis, again with the central region within 1.5λ/D of the star set to zero.
- A plot of planet contrast spectra for all planets at t=0.
- A plot of planet contrast phase curves at the reference wavelenth for all planets over the length of the orbital simulation.
- A plot of planet trajectories in the sky plane (relative to the host star) over the length of the orbital simulation.

Any transits and eclipses listed by the FITS file will have their ingress and egress times printed to the command line. It will also list any transits or eclipses that are in progress at the start or end of the simulation.

“`readfits-anim.py`” is a build of “`readfits.py`” that produces an animated version of the first plot (the image of the scene including disk and planets). By default, it runs through all of the timesteps in the FITS file at 60 fps.
Note*: this script requires the separate* FFmpeg *software to be installed, along with the Python* `ffmpeg` *module.*

“`readfits-flipbook.py`” is a build of “`readfits.py`” that outputs an animated version of the scene to the screen via multiple still images (not a single animation file).
Note*: this script outputs directly to the screen and works at runtime* ***only****. No output file is produced.*

4.4 Testing Resources and Benchmarks

A sample scene output file based on `solar_system.txt` is included for reference in the `output` directory. A sample stellar image file for the same scene. is included in the `teststar` directory.

The included **`test_system.txt`** file is the recommended test for a single-system scene generation. It is a Solar system simulation, with the 8 planets replaced with 3 copies of Earth using the disk-averaged, phase-resolved, and lat-lon-resolved spectra, allowing all 3 cases to be tested.

The included **`target_list8.txt`** file is the recommended test for the multi-system universe generation. This will apply the full random system generation to 8 target stars, allowing both the serial and parallel operations to be tested.

Several source files for ExoVista contain comment blocks that can be uncommented to run additional tests, or to generate non-standard output files.

Warning*: it is recommended to reduce the integration time for tests that run every timestep. For typical inputs, this may amount to several thousand files.*

The **`add_background`** module includes a code block to generate a test image of the disk + background of a scene, as generated by the Haystacks model, with the star and planet spectra or the full output FITS file.

Note*:* `add_background()` *has not been fully tested.*

In **`generate_scene.generate_scene()`**, at several points where `make_starmap.get_combined_spectra()` is called, there are additional calls that may be uncommented to `make_starmap.star_map_ortho()` to return a pixel grid of the stellar image, and/or calls to `make_star_map.get_data_cube()` to make a spectral data cube of the stellar image. Depending on when and out they are called this can be the star as seen by the observer or by any of the planets. Both of these functions also include code blocks to send them to output files in the `startest` folder.

Note*: there is also an option to compute the limb darkening map at a different stellar pixel scale, which may be used for a coronagraphic model over a range of wavelengths.*

The **`make_starmap.get_single_spectrum()`** function includes a code block to generate a plot of the four source spectra and output interpolated spectrum from that function. By default, this plot saves to "`startest/testspectrum.png.`" This block is intended to be used as a one-off test, given that the function is called several times for each combined spectrum.

The **`make_starmap.get_combined_spectrum()`** function includes a code block to generate a plot of the combined stellar spectrum and, optionally, its four components (quiescent, granulated, penumbra, and umbra). This block is intended to be used at runtime and generates one image for each timestep as seen by the observer and by each planet. These images are saved to the `startest` directory.

The **`make_starmap.star_map_ortho()`** function includes a code block to generate .png files for the stellar disk, which show limb darkening and starspots. By default, these will be in the artificial RGB colors used for internal handling, but "true color" images can be made by editing the `star_color`, `c_penumbra`, and `c_umbra` variables. This block is intended to be used at runtime and generates one image for each timestep as seen by the observer and by each planet. These images are saved to the `startest` directory.

The **`make_starmap.get_data_cube()`** function includes a code block to generate a spectral data cube for the stellar image across a wavelength range, which may be used for coronagraph modeling. This data cube is for the star as seen by the observer and is intended to be used as a one-off test. By default, the data cube is saved to "`output/stellardisk.fits.`"

***Note**: the `make_starmap` module at this time also includes a lot of material for alternate implementations for the starspot image generation. These implementations are meant to be more accurate by computing the true projected shape of a starspot of non-zero size onto the stellar disk, rather than an elliptical approximation. However, this is too slow to be used at runtime.*

Benchmarks

Runtimes for the solar_system.dat scene, with a 10-year integration time:

2026 MacBook Pro with Apple M5 CPU: 4 minutes, 55 seconds

2025 Lenovo PC with Intel Core Ultra 7 155H CPU: 4 minutes, 47 seconds

5. Input Files

5.1 Stellar Parameters and Naming Format

ExoVista uses a specific set of parameters for its stellar models. These are:

- **ID:** a numerical index
- **HIP:** Hipparcos Catalog number
- **TYC:** Tycho or Tycho-2 catalog number.
  Note*: this is the recommended column in which to place proper names as an alternative to the catalog number.*
- **Dist:** distance in pc
- **M_V:** absolute V-band magnitude
  Note*: this is used only for calculating* Vmag *in single system mode when* Vmag *is absent.*
- Apparent magnitudes **Umag**, **Bmag**, **Vmag**, **Rmag**, **Imag**, **Jmag**, **Hmag**, and **Kmag**
- **Type:** spectral type
  Note*: stars that are neither Main Sequence stars nor subgiants will be skipped in the target list.*
- **Lstar:** luminosity in M_Sun.
  Note*: stars with mass >100 M_Sun will be skipped in the target list.*
- **Logg:** surface gravity in cm s^{-2}.
  Note*: stars with logg>5.25 will be skipped in the target list. (This is a limitation of the dust map generation.)*
- **Teff:** effective temperature in K.
- **Angdiam:** angular diameter in mas
- **Mass:** mass in M_sun
- **Rstar:** radius in R_sun
- **RA** and **Dec:** right ascension and declination in decimal degrees
- **pmRA** and **pmDec:** proper motion in mas/yr
- **BmV:** B-V color
- **PA:** position angle of orbital plane in degrees
- **I:** inclination of orbital plane in degrees
- **Spectrum:** a spectrum file name to use in place of the spectral model library

In order to handle input files from different sources, which may have different formats, ExoVista is designed to handle many common variants of the names of the stellar parameters in the input files. However, some limitations still apply. The rules for stellar parameter names are as follows:

- Parameter names may not contain spaces.
- Names are NOT case-sensitive.
- Names are stripped of underscore characters before parsing.
- ExoVista's internal parameter names are compared only with the beginnings of the names in the input files, not with internal substrings.
- Common variants are allowed: `SpT` for `Type`, `Lum` for `Lstar`, `mstar` for `mass`, and `rad` for `rstar` (`RA` is de-aliased from `rad`).

5.2 The Planetary System File

***Note**: in this file, if duplicate stellar parameters are included, only the **last** entry of each duplicate will be used.*

The input file for a user-defined planetary system requires three sections to be specified in order: the star, the planets, and the (exozodiacal) disks, followed by an optional fourth section for observational settings. (This order is required because the data structures for the later sections depend partially on the earlier ones.)

The first line of the input file should read:

```
Star
```

ExoVista expects to see this keyword before any parameters. After this, the parameters for the stellar model should be listed one per line. For example:

```
ID    999
Type  G2V
Lstar 1.0
```

Not all possible parameters are needed to build the stellar model, but a few are required. The required parameters are:

- **Lstar**
- **Dist**
- **Type**
- Either **Vmag** or **M_V** (Vmag only in the stellar target list)
- Either **Umag** or **Bmag**
- At least one of **Rmag**, **Imag**, **Jmag**, **Hmag**, or **Kmag**

***Note**:* ExoVistaSystem.py *will use **default values** (usually zeros) if any of these parameters are missing, which may produce unstable behavior.*

Three optional parameters are also of particular interest:

- **ID:** This index number is placed at the beginning of the output filename. If it is not included, it will default to zero for a single system and index starting from zero for a list of targets.
  ***Warning**: the ID should be a positive integer, as the hyphens in negative numbers cause parsing issues in the post-processing routines.*
- A **catalog number** (usually **HIP**) is not required, but it is likely to cause confusion in the output filenames if it is not included.
- **Spectrum** allows ExoVista's internal stellar model spectrum to be replaced by a real spectrum. The spectrum file should have two columns for wavelength in nm and stellar surface flux in erg s^{-1} cm^{-2} Hz^{-1} sr^{-1}. The included modelspectrum.dat file provides an example spectrum for testing purposes, but it is based on ExoVista's own spectral model for a Sun-like star.

The second section is denoted by the keyword:

`Planets`

The next line is a header of the planet parameters in any order, which is then followed by a table of all planets in the system.

***Note**: a star cannot have more than 30 planets.*

There should be 9 columns in this section. The planet parameters are:

- **`M:`** mass in M_Earth
- **`R:`** radius in R_Earth
- The six orbital parameters, **`a`**, **`e`**, **`i`**, **`longnode`**, **`argperi`**, and **`meananom`** (in AU and decimal degrees where applicable)
- **`Albedo:`** the albedo file for the planet found in the "`geometric_albedo_files`" subdirectory, excluding suffix

The third section is denoted by the keyword:

`Disks`

The next line is a header of disk parameters in any order, which is then followed by a table of all disk components.

***Note**: a star cannot have more than 3 disk components.*

The disk model is described in detail in Appendix B.3. There should be 12 columns in this section. The disk parameters are:

- **`Nzodis:`** disk surface density at the location of an Earth twin, as a multiple of the zodiacal reference disk of 22 mag/arcsec^2
- The four shape parameters, **`r`**, **`dror`**, **`rinner`**, and **`hor`** (in AU where applicable)
- The six scattering parameters, **`g0`**, **`g1`**, **`g2`**, **`w0`**, **`w1`**, and **`w2`**
- **`Composition:`** the disk material found in the "`lqq_files`" subdirectory

The fourth section may be omitted. If present, it is denoted by the keyword:

`Settings`

After this, similar to the "Star" section, the parameters should be listed one per line. Any parameters in the `Settings` dataclass may be included, but none are required. They do not affect the planetary system directly. These settings are needed primarily in the use case of recomputing an existing scene with the same simulated observations. The output of `parsefits.py` will include all the needed parameters automatically.

5.3 The Stellar Target List

***Note**: in this file, if duplicate stellar parameters are included, only the **first** entry of each duplicate will be used.*

The stellar target list input file requires only the stellar parameters to be defined. The planets and disks will be defined procedurally. The first line of this file should be a list of columns in the stellar table. Each column name should be separated by whitespace and should have no internal spaces.

In each subsequent row, the parameters should be separated by commas "`,`" or vertical bars "`|`". Omitted entries in the table should be listed as "`NaN`".

The required column names in this file are the same as the required stellar parameters in the single system file listed in Section 5.1, except that `Vmag` must be used and not `M_V`.

***Note**:* `ExoVista.py` *will **halt** if any of the required parameters are missing.*

***Warning**: some additional parameters may be required for specific use cases, such as sky coordinates and proper motions.*

6. Data Files

A number of supplementary data files are used by ExoVista to generate planet and disk distributions and compute scenes. You may wish to modify, add to, or replace some of these files to customize your simulated universe. These supplementary files are summarized below. "`planetbins.dat`" and "`albedo_list.csv`" are the simplest files to modify and are thus described in detail.

6.1 Grid of Planet Types

`planetbins.dat` contains a grid of planet types bounded in mass-semi-major axis-space. If `usebins` is enabled, the bounding boxes for this grid are used by `generate_planets()` to create exact expected numbers of planets for each desired planet type. The radius and stellar flux limits are listed as separate arrays.

***Note**: ExoVista expects the smallest and largest bin edges in each array to be wider than the actual distribution of planets in the occurrence rate tables. If this is not the case, it may result in unstable behavior at the edges of the distribution.*

This file should begin with the keyword **`Radius`** on the first line.

The second line is read in to ExoVista as the **`rbound`** array and contains a 1-D array of bin edges for planet types in radius space, in Earth radii. The included version of `planetbins.dat` defines bins of sub-Earths, super-Earths, sub-Neptunes, Neptunes, and Jupiters based on the definitions in Kopparapu et al. (2018).

***Warning**: it is not possible to include a bin edge between 12.28 Earth radii and the maximum planet size (14.31 R_E before the radius spread is applied). This restriction is necessary to convert radius bins to mass bins correctly.*

The third line should contain a keyword of either **`Flux`** or **`Orbital_Distance`**. After this should be a table of corresponding values of either semi-major axes in AU (normalized to 1 L_sun) or stellar instellations in F_earth. If the keyword `Flux` is included, the table is converted to semi-major axes by the equation `a = 1/sqrt(flux)`.

This table is read in as the **abound** array, and it should contain one fewer line than the length of `rbound` (that is, one for each radius bin). This allows each radius bin to have a different set of semi-major axis bins. The included version of `planetbins.dat` defines 5 bins with the middle 3 being the "standard" definitions of hot, warm (habitable zone), and cold planets according to the definitions of Kopparapu et al. (2018). The outer two bins are values outside the range of their definitions.

6.2 Bounding Boxes for Albedo Files

`albedo_list.csv` contains a list of albedo files to assign to planets and a bounding box for each in radius-semi-major-axis space in which they apply. When planets are generated by the code, each planet will be randomly assigned an albedo file from the set that overlap its position in *R*-*a*-space.

`albedo_list.csv` may be user-modified in order to define custom planet types. This file consists of a header followed by a list of planet types. It requires seven columns:

- **`Files`:** the albedo filename associated with each planet type in the `geometric_albedo_files` subdirectory, excluding suffix.
- **`rmin`** and **`rmax`:** the minimum and maximum radii for that planet type, in Earth radii.
- **`amin`** and **`amax`:** the minimum and maximum semi-major axie for that planet type (normalized to 1 Lsun), in AU.
- **`prob`:** the probability weight for that planet type. When an albedo file is assigned, the weights of all of the eligible planet types for that planet will be summed and normalized, and a file will be randomly selected from that distribution.
- **`EEC`:** a Boolean value for whether the planet type is an exo-Earth candidate (EEC). EECs have an adjusted lower radius bound based on their instellation, changing r_{min} to r_{min}/sqrt(a), as small planets can more readily retain an atmosphere when they are colder.
  ***Note**: by default, EEC albedo files completely override non-EEC albedo files, so non-EEC files will never be assigned within that bounding box. Non-EEC albedo files can be assigned a non-zero weight by adjusting the* `eecprob` *parameter in* `Settings` *to less than 1.0.*

The default bounding boxes for the included list of albedo files (solid) and planet types (dashed) are shown in Figure 1.

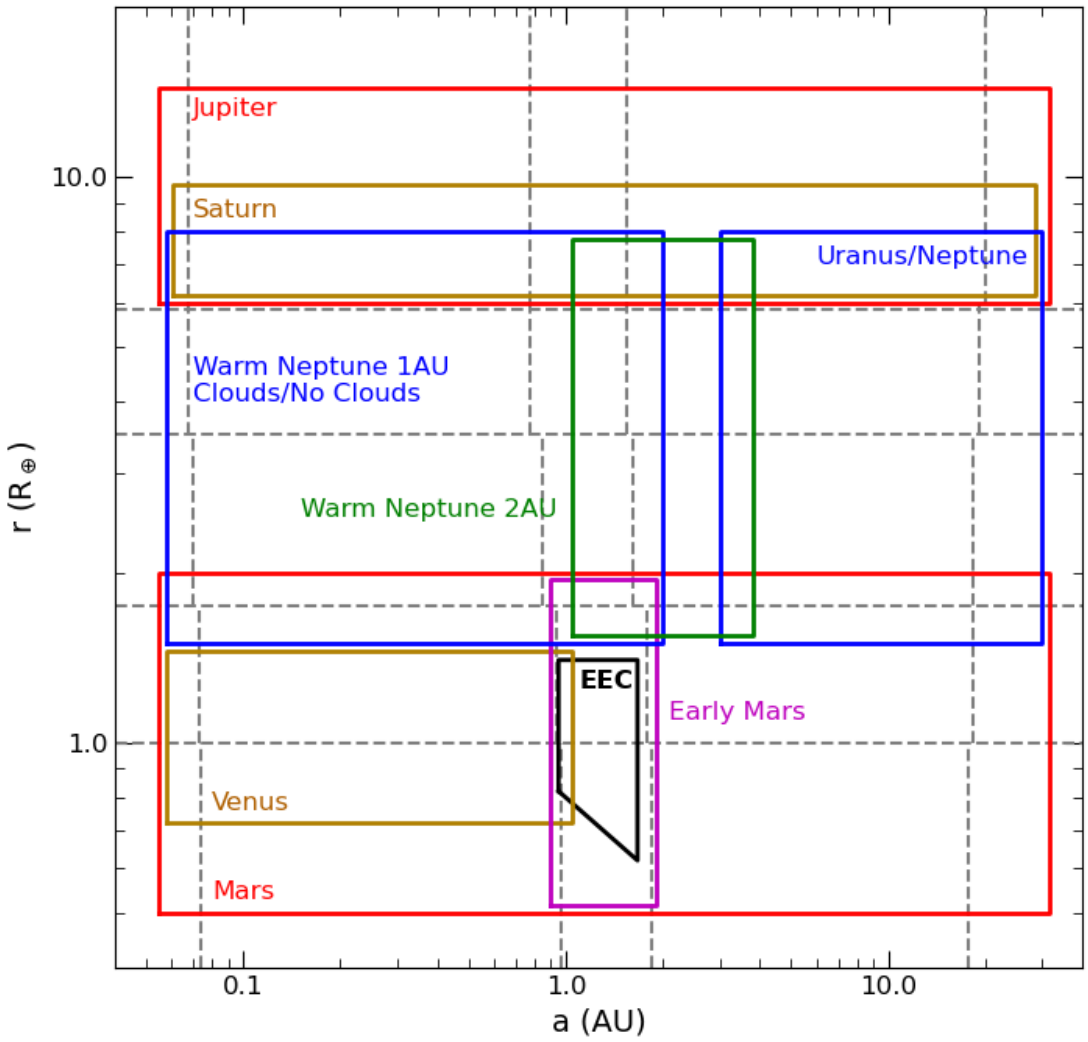


Figure 1: Bounding boxes for default albedo file assignments (solid) and planet types (dashed) set by the included `albedo_list.csv` file.

6.3 Variation in Phase Functions

`phase_spread.dat` is a table of bounds for the scaling factors for the phase function. If `randphase` is set to `True`, for isotropic albedo files (Lambertian-defined phase functions), each planet's phase function will be randomly scaled away from the Lambertian between the upper and lower bounds described by this file. This table begins with the header **Phase_Function** and is followed by a table of three columns:

- Phase angle in degrees.
- Minimum scale factor on the Lambertian.
- Maximum scale factor on the Lambertian.

The included version of this file is based on the spread in phase functions of observed Solar system objects presented in Sudarsky et al. (2005). (See Figure 2.)

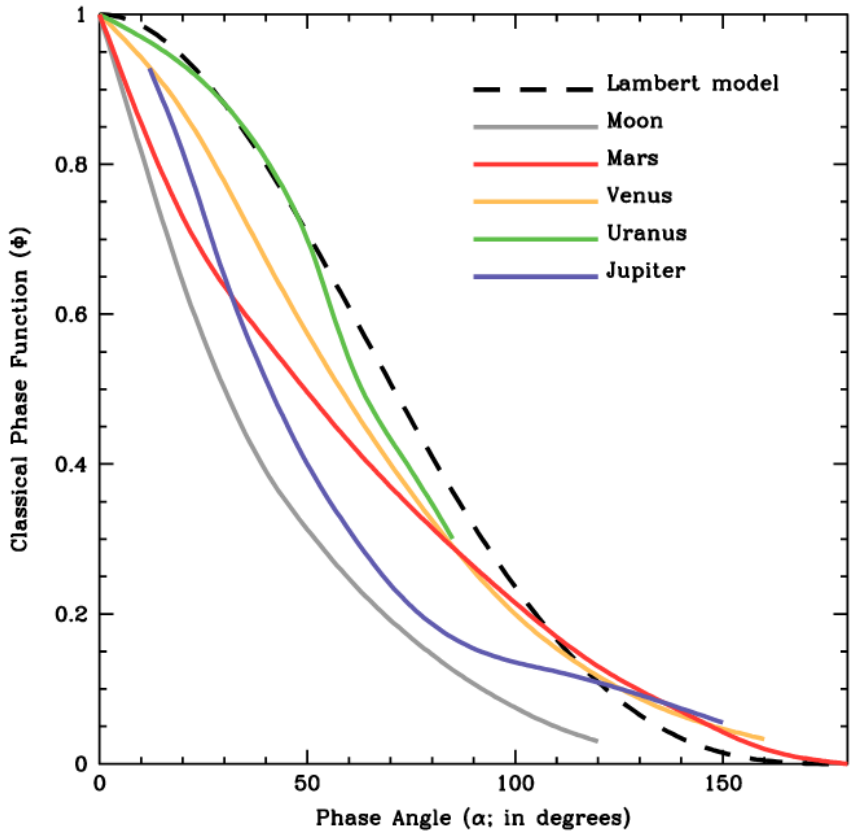


Figure 2: Phase curves of Solar system objects from Sudarsky et al. (2005), used for the default bounds in the phase function spread.

6.4 Stellar Properties and Spectra

`mamajek_dwarf.txt` is a table of median properties of Main Sequence stars by spectral type. ExoVista interpolates from this table to convert B-V colors from the stellar parameters input file to mass and effective temperature. Surface gravity is then computed from mass and radius. The citations for this table are listed in the file.

`fp00k2odfnew.pck` is a table of stellar spectrum models as a function of Teff and logg. These models are interpolated by ExoVista to generate the spectrum for each star in the input file. This file is based on the Castelli & Kurucz ATLAS9 stellar atmosphere models (IAU Symposium 210, 2003).
Note: *As of Version 2.5, this file is no longer used and is included only for backwards compatibility.*

6.5 Debris Disk Properties and Spectra

`nominal_maxL_distribution-Dec2019.fits` is a random distribution of 300,000 exozodiacal light fluxes assigned to disks by ExoVista, based on the LBTI HOSTS survey (Ertel et al., 2020).

The **`lqq_dir`** subdirectory contains optical cross section tables for many exozodiacal disk compositions. Each file contains absorption and scattering cross sections as a function of wavelength for a specific particle size and composition. These are then compiled into complete tables for a single composition by the `generate_scene.load_lqsca()` and `generate_scene.load_lqabs()` functions.

***Note**: a wider selection of dust compositions is in development.*

6.6 Albedo File Formats

The **`geometric_albedo_files`** subdirectory contains albedo spectra for many planetary types. These files are assigned to planets by the `generate_planets.assign_albedo_files()` function, and they are used to compute the planetary spectra.

Three types of albedo files can be read by ExoVista:

1. **Isotropic albedo**: a simple 2-column file listing a spectrum of wavelength in the first column and albedo in the second column. (Isotropic albedos are converted to phase-resolved albedos using a Lambert function.)
2. **Phase-resolved albedo**: these include a header listing the specific phase angles in degrees and the number of wavelength points at which the albedo is computed. *All* header rows must begin with a # symbol, and the list of phases must have the form:

   ```
   #PHASES: <phases separated by spaces>
   ```

   Each line after the header lists a wavelength followed by the albedo as a function of phase at that wavelength.
3. **Latitude-longitude-resolved albedo**: these include a header listing the specific longitudes (phases) and latitudes (inclinations) at which the albedo is computed, in degrees, along with the number of wavelength points. *All* header rows must begin with a # symbol, and the latitude and longitude lists must have the form:

   ```
   #LATITUDES: <latitudes separated by spaces>
   #LONGITUDES: <longitudes separated by spaces>
   ```

   Each line after the header includes a wavelength and a linearized array of albedo as a function of latitude and longitude, with longitude on the inner dimension.

***Note**: a wider selection of albedo files is in development.*

6.7 Planet Occurrence Rates

The **`occurrence_rates`** directory contains tables of occurrence rates of exoplanets based on Dulz et al. (2020), which are used to generate random planets with the correct distribution of parameters. Standard, optimistic, and pessimistic occurrence rates are included. The choice of occurrence rates used may be changed by setting the **bound** argument in `generate_planets.load_occurrence_rates()` to "`upper`" or "`lower`." The standard rates are used by default. The default "`Nominal`" occurrence rates are shown in Figure 3, and the default mass-radius relation from Chen & Kipping (2017) is shown in Figure 4.

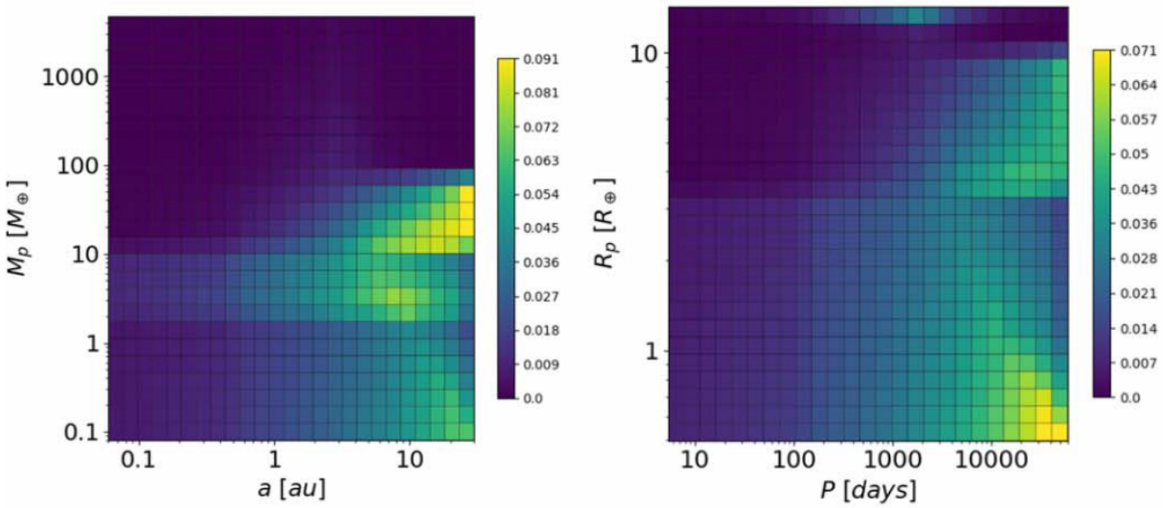


Figure 3: Default "Nominal" planet occurrence rates from Dulz et al. (2020).

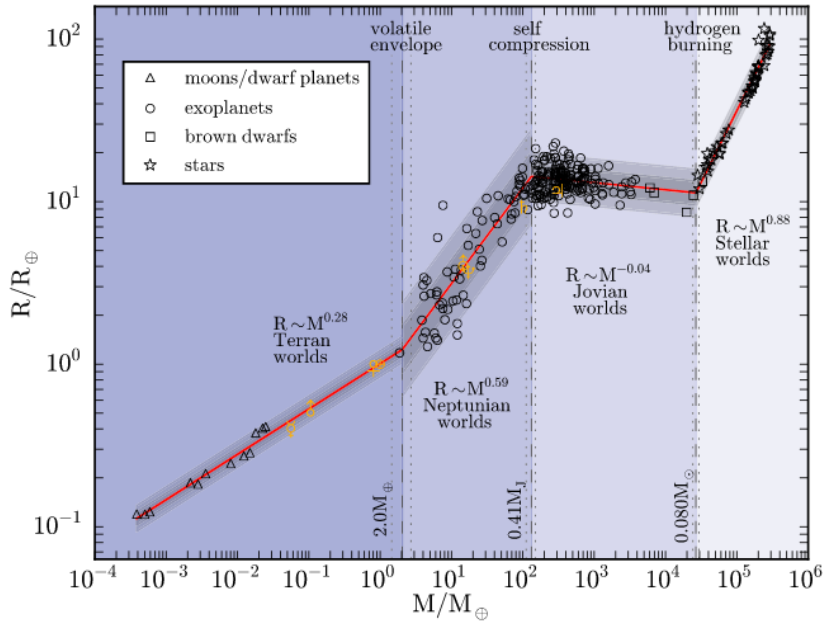


Figure 4: The default mass-radius relation from Chen & Kipping (2017).

7. Scientific and Computational Models

7.1 Stellar Target List and Stellar Model

The stellar target list for ExoVista is intended to be user-defined. However, the `master_target_list-usingDR2-50_pc.txt` file provided with the code contains the HabEx/LUVOIR master target list generated by combining the *Hipparcos* and *Gaia* DR2 target lists within 50 pc.

Note that this target list is not intended to be accurate on a star-by-star basis, and indeed, ExoVista internally uses model stellar spectra rather than observed spectra by default to simulate the stars. However, this target list should still be broadly representative of nearby main sequence and subgiant stars.

7.2 Planet Generation

Planets are generated by ExoVista with orbital parameters defined relative to the system midplane orientation. Planets are drawn from the occurrence rate maps of Dulz et al. (2020) in mass-semi-major axis space (with semi-major axes scaled to a 1 L_sun star), converted to a probability distribution. If bins for planet types are not used, these maps are divided into a regular grid. Applying bins imposes an extra set of bin edges on this grid, and the occurrence rates in each "pixel" are scaled according to their size in log-log space.

The Monte Carlo simulation defines a 3-D grid of random numbers, covering each pixel in the 2-D occurrence rate map for the total number of stars. Random numbers smaller than the occurrence rate in a given pixel assign one planet to that star with the corresponding parameters. A planet's exact parameters within its pixel are assigned randomly in log-log space.

***Note**: this means that the occurrence rate map must be a high enough in resolution that the expected number of planets **per star** is <1 for every pixel.*

Planets are drawn from the mass grid even though radii are known for more observed planets because *M(R)* is not a monotonic function, so there is ambiguity in converting radius to mass as opposed to the inverse. The default mass-radius relation is a strictly 1-dimensional function based on Chen & Kipping (2017). If `randrad` is enabled, random variation will be added to this function based on the "fractional dispersion" hyperparameters from that paper. A limit of 14.31 R_Earth is applied for planets with periods of >10 days (scaled with stellar luminosity).

When generating the pixel map of drawn planets per star, if planet types are specified, ExoVista will check the number of planets generated for each type across the full target list, and it will randomly add planets to empty star-pixels or remove them from filled star-pixels until the number for that planet type equals the expected number.

After the planet population is drawn, the remaining orbital elements are assigned randomly. However, eccentricities are set to zero by default, and inclinations are restricted to <5 degrees by default.

Once the planets are generated, they are randomly assigned to stars in the target list, with their semi-major axes being scaled according to the host star's luminosity. After adding the planets to stars, their orbital stability is checked based on a mutual Hill sphere heuristic. For any pair of planets with $\Delta > 6$, where Δ = separation/mutual Hill radius, the less massive planet is removed. After this stability check, new planets are drawn to replace the removed ones, and the process is iterated until all planets in the draw have been assigned and are stable. If it is not possible to assign all of the planets in the draw, the loop halts after 50 iterations pass with no net planets successfully added, or after 200 total iterations, whichever comes first.

***Note**: Dulz et al. (2020) adopted a stability criterion of $\Delta > 9$, but this greatly slows the process of assigning planets due to the large number of rejections, so ExoVista adopts a more lenient*

criterion. The resulting systems are expected to be "plausible," but are not necessarily stable on Gyr timescales.

***Note**: ExoVista does not assume any correlation between planet types or multiplicities within a given system. All planets are equally likely to occur with any type of neighbors (subject to the stability criterion). This means that it does not account for the "peas-in-a-pod" phenomenon in which the sizes and period ratios of planets within a system are correlated. Generation of more realistic planetary systems based on the work of Howe et al. (2025) is in development.*

7.3 Disk Model

The debris disk data structure contains 3 parameters that are not listed in the individual planetary system input files. These are **n**, the number of disk components, along with **longnode** and **i**, which define the disk orientation. n has a minimum value of 1 and a maximum value of 3. However, at present, longnode and i are not implemented, and all disks are assigned the same orientation as the system midplane.

By default, each star is assigned a 2-component debris disk, in which the inner component corresponds to our Solar system's Zodiacal disk. This inner component is also assigned absolute bounds within which it can be placed of 0.5 and 5.0 AU. The outer component is assigned bounds of 5 and 50 AU, and a third component, if present, is assigned bounds of 50 and 500 AU. These values can be changed by using the **r_min** and **r_max** parameters in Settings.

The inner component of each disk is randomly assigned a density relative to our Zodiacal disk based on the exozodi distribution of on the LBTI HOSTS survey (Ertel et al., 2020), which has a median of 3 zodis. The outer component is assigned a density that is a multiple of the inner component between 0.2 and 5.0, randomly distributed in log-space. The disk composition is randomly selected from the available compositions in the lqq_files directory.

***Note**: ExoVista assumes optically thin disks, such that surface brightness is directly proportional to density*.

For each star, the disk model is structured with a belt shape described by 4 shape parameters. The location of the belt is selected randomly in log-space from the set of all sufficiently large regions of stability between planets within that disk's bounds for placement. "Stable" regions are defined as all regions more than 3 Hill radii away from any planet. This belt is:

- **r**: the radius of peak density (i.e. the center of the belt). The valid locations for r are subject to a minimum fractional belt width of dr/r > 0.05.
- **dror:** the fractional width of the belt, dr/r, randomly selected from the range 0.05 to 0.30, subject to the stability limits.
- **rinner**: the inner truncation radius of the disk caused by gravitational perturbations by interior giant planets. This is set to zero if there are no planets interior to r with a mass >100 M_Earth. If interior giant planets are present, it is set to min(r,1.1*a*(1+e)) for the most massive (not nearest) interior planet.
- **hor**: the vertical fractional scale height of the disk, h/r, randomly selected from the range 0.03 to 0.2.

***Note**: if no value of* dror *in the allowed bound meets the stability criteria, the disk density is reset to zero, and no disk is included.*

The disk density within the belt is assigned a Gaussian density distribution with circumstellar radius r, and a Dohnanyi particle size distribution. Exterior to the belt, the density falls off with a power law of $r^{-1.5}$. Interior to the belt, the density falls off based on a collisional Poynting-

Robertson drag model from Wyatt. An additional parameter, `eta`, is the ratio of the Poynting-Robertson timescale to the collision timescale, which is computed analytically. Finally, interior to the truncation radius (if present), the density falls off faster, with a power law of r^3.

***Note**: ExoVista does not model mean motion resonant ring structures, and all disks are assumed to be circular and azimuthally symmetric. This is necessary in part to avoid the need to model the disk over time.*

Asymmetric scattering of starlight off dust particles in the disk is modeled by a linear combination of 3 Henyey-Greenstein phase functions. The asymmetry parameters of these functions, **`g0`**, **`g1`**, and **`g2`**, are randomly selected from the ranges 0.8 to 0.995, 0.35 to 0.8 and -0.30 to 0.35, respectively. The weights on the scattering functions are randomly selected such that **`w0`** falls in the range 0.4 to 0.8; **`w1`** falls in the range 0.1 to `1-w0`, and **`w2`**=`1-w0-w1`.

ExoVista models only scattering of light by the disk, not emission or absorption, due to the lower spectral resolution needed to accurately model scattering. Additionally, it does not rely on Mie scattering due to the computationally-intensive modelling required for it and instead reads scattering coefficients from files. The full scattering spectrum is assembled from coefficients for many different grain sizes with a size resolution of s/ds = 5. The range of grain sizes is determined by the files in `lqq_dir`, which extends from the blowout size (assumed to be 0.5 microns for all stars) to 100 times the maximum wavelength observed.

Plots illustrating the effect of the four disk shape parameters (`nzodis`, `r0`, `dror`, and `rinner`) on the radial disk surface density profile are shown in Figure 5.

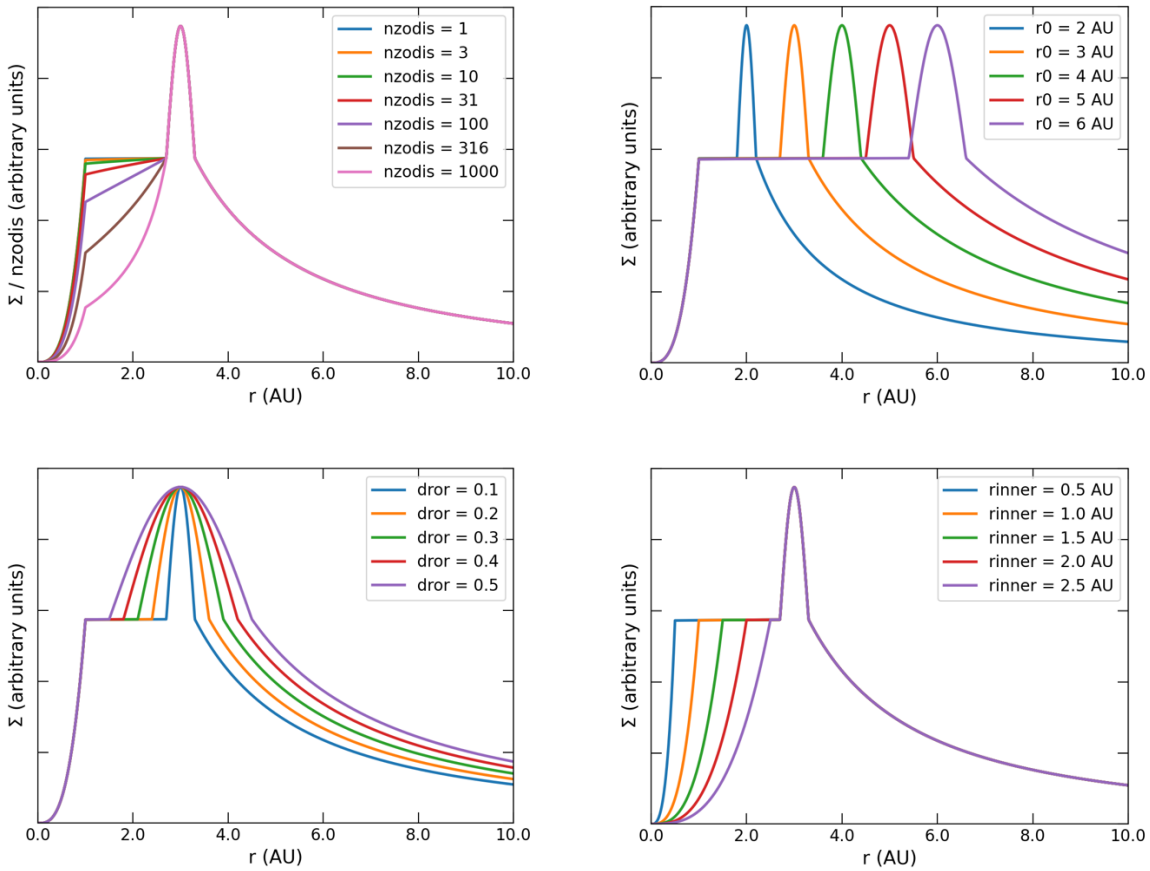


Figure 5: Example disk surface density profiles demonstrating the effect of the shape parameters.

8. Output File Format

For each star, `generate_scene.generate_scene()` produces a single FITS file. The sizes of these files vary with the spectral resolution of the planets and disks and the integration time for the N-body integrator. For the default spectral resolutions and an integration time of 10 years, the filesize is about 25 MB. Ideally, this will be roughly the largest file size produced by "standard" use cases.

The FITS files have multiple extensions. The data contained in each extension is as follows:

Extension #	Data description
0	Vector of wavelength values for the star and planets
1	Vector of wavelength values for the debris disk
2	3D debris disk contrast cube (x * y * lambda + noise map)
3	2D transit/eclipse events array (num. events * 4)
4	3D array of starspot properties (time * num. spots * 4)
5	2D stellar data array (time * position + orbit + spectrum)
6…N_EXT	2D planet data array (time * position + orbit + spectrum)

Extension 0: Wavelength values for the star and planets.
Description: a 1D vector containing the wavelengths (in microns) at which the stellar flux and planet contrast were calculated.

Key header parameters:
NAXIS1: length of wavelength vector (# of wavelengths)
VERSION: the version number of the code (used to set up post-processing routines)
N_EXT: maximum extension number (with the planet data being in extensions 5 to N_EXT)
SPECRES: spectral resolution of wavelength vector
LAMMIN: minimum wavelength
LAMMAX: maximum wavelength

Extension 1: Wavelength values for the debris disk contrast cube.
Description: a 1D vector containing the wavelengths (in microns) at which disk contrast was calculated.

Key header parameters:
NAXIS1: length of wavelength vector (# of wavelengths)
SPECRES: spectral resolution of wavelength vector
LAMMIN: minimum wavelength
LAMMAX: maximum wavelength

Extension 2: Debris disk contrast cube.
Description: a 3D cube (xpix * ypix * wavelengths+1) of disk flux divided by stellar flux. To convert this back into a disk flux, interpolate the cube to the desired wavelengths, then multiply by the stellar flux at those wavelengths.

***Note**: The number of entries in the last dimension is equal to the number of wavelengths+1 because the last entry is not a contrast map, but a 2D map estimating the fractional numerical noise in the contrast calculations.*

Key header parameters:
NAXIS1: # of pixels in x dimension
NAXIS2: # of pixels in y dimension
NAXIS3: # of wavelengths+1
SPECRES: spectral resolution of wavelength vector
PXSCLMAS: pixel scale in milli-arcseconds
IWA: inner working angle of the coronagraph in arcseconds
DUSTBLOW: the dust blowout particle size in microns
TSUB: the dust sublimation temperature in kelvins
LNGND-N: longitude of the ascending node of the Nth disk component (degrees)
I-N: inclination of the Nth disk component relative to system midplane (degrees)
NZODIS-N: density in zodis of the Nth disk component
R-N: circumstellar distance of the peak density of the Nth disk component (AU)
DROR-N: value of the normalized Gaussian peak width of the Nth disk component
RINNER-N: value of the inner truncation radius of the Nth disk component (AU)
ETA-N: ratio of PR drag time to collision time for the blowout size for the Nth disk component
HOR-N: normalized scale height for the Nth disk component
G0-N to G2-N: 3 values of scattering asymmetry parameters for the Nth disk component
W0-N to W2-N: 3 weights for each HG scattering phase function for the Nth disk component
MINSIZE: minimum grain size considered
MAXSIZE: maximum grain size considered

Extension 3: transit and eclipse times.
Description: a 2D array (number of events * 4) containing the time of each ingress and egress of a planet in transit or secondary eclipse, the index of the planet involved, and two values indicating the specific type of event. The data structure is organized as follows:

> `data[0,i]`: the time of the event in days
> `data[1,i]`: the numerical designation of the planet involved in the event
> `data[2,i]`: the position of the planet before the event: `+1` for transit, `-1` for eclipse, or `0` for neither
> `data[3,i]`: the position of the planet after the event: `+1` for transit, `-1` for eclipse, or `0` for neither

If a planet is in transit or eclipse at the start or end of the integration time, the third and fourth values will be `(+1, +1)` or `(-1, -1)`, respectively. If it is a true ingress or egress event, the values will have opposite signs. If there are no transits or secondary eclipses in the integration time (which is likely to be the case for most systems that are not nearly edge-on), this structure will contain a single event with all values set to `0`.

Key header parameters:
NAXIS1: the number of ingress and egress events recorded
NAXIS2: the number of entries for each event (4)
BASELINE: the length of integration time for the file, in days

Extension 4: starspot data.
Description: a 3D array (time * num. spots * 4) containing the location, area, and area ratio of each of the starspots over time. The data structure is organized as follows:

`data[i,j,k]`: ith time step, jth spot, kth data value
`data[i,j,0]`: the spot latitude in decimal degrees
`data[i,j,1]`: the spot longitude in decimal degrees
`data[i,j,2]`: the spot area in cm^2
`data[i,j,3]`: the penumbra-to-umbra area ratio of the spot

Extension 5: stellar data.
Description: a 2D array (time * wavelengths+15) containing the time, position, orbit, and spectrum of the star for all time values. The data structure is organized as follows:

`data[i,j]`: ith time step, jth data value
`data[i,0]`: simulation time (years)
`data[i,1]`: x coordinate of star (in pixels) at ith time
`data[i,2]`: y coordinate of star (in pixels) at ith time
`data[i,3:9]`: placeholder values for heliocentric orbital elements at ith time (set to zero for the star)
`data[i,9:15]`: barycentric cartesian coordinates for the star at the ith time; x, y, z positions (AU) and vx, vy, vz velocities (AU/yr)
`data[i,15]`: placeholder value for phase angle (set to zero for the star)
`data[i,16:16+nlambda]`: spectrum of star (in Jy) at ith time

Key header parameters:
NAXIS1: # of time values
NAXIS2: # of data values (wavelengths+15) for each time value
PA: position angle of system midplane (decimal degrees)
I: inclination of system midplane (decimal degrees)
STARID: an internal catalog ID # for the star
RA: right ascension of star (decimal degrees)
DEC: declination of star (decimal degrees)

*MAG: stellar empirical magnitude in the * filter band
M_V: absolute V-band magnitude of star
DIST: distance to star (pc)
TYPE: spectral type of star
LSTAR: bolometric stellar luminosity (L_Sun)
TEFF: stellar effective temperature (K)
ANGDIAM: angular diameter of star (mas)
MASS: stellar mass (M_Sun)
LOGG: log(stellar surface gravity) (cm/s^2)
RSTAR: stellar radius (R_Sun)
WDS_SEP: most recent separation of companion in WDS catalog, if it exists (arcsec)
WDS_DMAG: delta mag of companion in WDS catalog, if it exists
PMRA: proper motion in RA (mas/yr)
PMDEC: proper motion in DEC (mas/yr)
PXSCLMAS: pixel scale (mas)

Extensions 6 to N_EXT: planet data.
Description: a 2D array (time x wavelengths+15) containing the time, position, orbit, and **contrast** spectrum of a specific planet for all time values. The data structure is organized as follows:

`data[i,j]`: ith time value, jth data value
`data[i,0]`: simulation time (years)
`data[i,1]`: x coordinate of planet (in pixels) at ith time
`data[i,2]`: y coordinate of planet (in pixels) at ith time
`data[i,3:9]`: heliocentric orbital elements at ith time; semi-major axis (AU), eccentricity, inclination (degrees), longitude of ascending node (degrees), argument of periastron (degrees), mean anomaly (degrees)
`data[i,9:15]`: barycentric cartesian coordinates at ith time; x, y, z positions (AU) and vx, vy, vz velocities (AU/yr)
`data[i,15]`: phase angle of the planet at ith time in degrees
`data[i,16:16+nlambda]`: **contrast** spectrum of planet with the star at ith time

Key header parameters
NAXIS1: # of time values
NAXIS2: # of data values (wavelengths+15) for each time value
M: planet mass (M_Earth)
R: planet radius (R_Earth)
ALBEDO_F: geometric albedo filename
PXSCLMAS: pixel scale (mas)

Appendix A: Notices and Disclaimers

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Appendix B: ExoVista API

B.1 Module `load_stars`

`load_stars.load_target_list(target_list_file)`

Internal function used by `load_stars()` to read in the target list file and convert it to a DataFrame for further processing. It also computes color values and angular diameters.

Parameters:

`target_list_file`: *string*; file name for list of target stars

Returns:

`target_list`: *DataFrame*; the table of stellar parameters for stars that pass the filter

`load_stars.load_stars(target_list_file)`

Reads in a table of target star parameters and converts it to the DataFrame format used by ExoVista. It filers out stars that have insufficient data or are outside the limits for ExoVista. It also computes necessary the derived quantities, `mass`, `Teff`, `rstar`, and `logg` for each star.

Parameters:

`target_list_file`: *string*; file name for list of target stars

Returns:

`target_list`: *DataFrame*; the table of stellar parameters for stars that pass the filter

`nexozodis`: *array (floats)* or *None*; a list of exozodiacal densities to replace the randomly generated ones. If the "nexozodis" is not included in the target list file, this has a value of None.

B.2 Module `generate_planets`

`generate_planets.mass_to_radius(M, rng, a=None, randrad=False)`

Converts planetary masses to radii using a three-part piecewise empirical function. This is used to convert occurrence rates from mass-space to radius-space.

Parameters:

`M`: *array (floats)*; an array of planet masses.

`rng`: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_planets()`, which carries the same random seed over to `mass_to_radius()`.

`a`: *array (floats)*; an array of semi-major axes of planets, scaled with stellar luminosity. This is used to allow hot Jupiters to bypass the radius limit if `randrad` is applied. Default behavior does not allow any planets to bypass the radius limit.

`randrad`: *bool*; if `True`, random variation is added to the computed planet radii, carried over from the main `Settings` object; default is `False`. *Note: not compatible with* `usebins`.

Returns:

`R`: *array (floats)*; a corresponding array of planet masses.

`generate_planets.radius_to_mass(R)`

Converts planetary radii to masses using the inverse of the piecewise mass-to-radius function. This is used to convert boundaries for planet types from radius-space to mass-space in order to divide the occurrence rate grid accurately.

***Note**: because the inverse function M(R) is not monotonic, this function cannot be evaluated for radii >12.28 R_J and will return a value of -1 for these radii.*

Parameters:

`R`: *array (floats)*; an array of planet radii.

Returns:

`M`: *array (floats)*; a corresponding array of planet radii.

`generate_planets.generate_planets(stars, settings, bound='', nomcdraw=False, addearth=False, usebins=False, subdivide=1)`

Creates a randomized array of planets and orbital parameters associated with the input star list. Each star is given a list of 30 planets to ensure that there are enough to cover all of the planets assigned to the star. Unassigned slots are set to zeros. The planets are generated iteratively, first creating a random sample of the expected number of planets and assigning them to the stars, then removing those that are dynamically unstable. This process is then repeated until the final number of planets matches the expected number, or no new planets can be added without creating dynamical instabilities.

Parameters:

`stars`: *DataFrame*; a table of stellar parameters

`settings`: `Settings` *object*; contains all of the settable code parameters.

bound: *string, optional*; set to 'upper' or 'lower' to use the optimistic or pessimistic bounds of the planet occurrence rates, respectively. Default is '' (empty string), which uses the nominal occurrence rates.

`nomcdraw`: *bool, optional*; if `True`, ExoVista bypasses the Monte Carlo draw and assigns planets to stars strictly based on occurrence rates. Default is `False`.

`addearth`: *bool, optional*; if `True`, ExoVista will add an Earth twin to every planetary system. These Earth twins have negligible mass, so they do not disrupt stability or disk structure. Their orbital distance is scaled to the luminosity of the star, and they have zero eccentricity so that the phase angle is exactly lined up with quadrature at t=0. Default is `False`.

`usebins`: *bool, optional*; if `True`, ExoVista will assign planets to bins in radius and semi-major axis based on planet types instead of randomly to the whole grid. These bins are read in from the file `planetbins.dat`. The occurrence rate will be adjusted from the Monte Carlo draw so that each planet type bin includes exactly the expected number of planets from the occurrence rate table (unless stability constraints prevent this). Default is `False`.

`subdivide`: *int, optional*; multiplies the grid size of the occurrence rate distribution used to assign planets. (The tables have a native resolution of 100x100 in M-a space.) Minimum value is 1; maximum value is 10. Default is 1.

Returns:

`plorb`: *3-D array (floats)*; planet parameters (nstars x 30 x 8)

`albedos`: *2-D array (floats)*; albedo file names assigned to planets (nstars x 30)

generate_planets.load_occurrence_rates(subdivide=1, bound='', mass=True, usebins=False)

Wrapper that calls the correct version of `load_occurrence_rates` to read the desired table of occurrence rates. The bound and `mass` parameters are used to generate the name of the correct file.
***Note**: This wrapper is not needed for ExoVista's current functionality. It is included to allow the possibility of future expansion with different occurrence rate files.*

Parameters:

`subdivide`: see below

bound: *string, optional*; set to 'upper' or 'lower' to use the optimistic or pessimistic bounds of the planet occurrence rates, respectively. Default is '' (empty string), which uses the nominal occurrence rates.

`mass`: *bool, optional*; if `True`, the occurrence rates are read in M-a-space. If `False`, the occurrence rates are read in R-P-space and then converted to M-a-space for the purpose of generating planet parameters. Default is `True`.

`usebins`: *bool, optional*; if `True`, ExoVista will assign planets to bins in radius and semi-major axis based on planet types instead of randomly to the whole grid. Default is `False`.

Returns:

Output of desired `load_occurrence_rates_convolved()` function.

generate_planets.load_occurrence_rates_convolved(filepath, subdivide=1, usebins=False)

Reads in a table of planet occurrence rates in radius-period space, which is used to distribute planets to the stars. Notably, this version of the routine convolves the occurrence rates with the mass-radius dispersion relations in Chen & Kipping (2017) to smooth over the transition between the radius-based rates used for smaller planets and the mass-based rates used for giant planets.

Parameters:

`filepath`: *string*; the location and prefix of the occurrence rate files to be read. Generated automatically by `generate_planets.load_occurrence_rates()`, and the code used the "`*Mass.csv`" and "`*Radius.csv`" files where appropriate.

`subdivide`: *int, optional*; multiplies the grid size of the occurrence rate distribution used to assign planets. Minimum value is 1; maximum value is 10. Default is 1.

usebins: *bool, optional*; if True, ExoVista will assign planets to bins in radius and semi-major axis based on planet types instead of randomly. Default is False.

Returns:

newoccrate: *2-D array (floats)*; an array of planet occurrence rates in M-a- and R-a-space, as appropriate, of the specified grid size.

medge, redge, and **aedge**: *2-D arrays (floats)*; arrays of M-, R-, and a-edge values of the occurrence rate table, respectively. These arrays combine to give the ordered pairs of the coordinates in their respective occurrence rate maps.

mmid, **rmid**, and **amid**: *2-D arrays (floats)*; arrays of M-, R-, and a-midpoint values of the occurrence rate table, respectively. These arrays combine to give the ordered pairs of the coordinates in their respective occurrence rate maps.

generate_planets.load_occurrence_rates_combined(filepath, subdivide=1, usebins=False)

Reads in a table of planet occurrence rates in radius-period space, which is used to distribute planets to the stars. This version has the same inputs and outputs, but it does not perform a convolution and leaves a hard cut between the radius-based and mass-based occurrence rate tables.

Parameters:

filepath: *string*; the location and prefix of the occurrence rate files to be read. Generated automatically by generate_planets.load_occurrence_rates(), and the code used the "*Mass.csv" and "*Radius.csv" files where appropriate.

subdivide: *int, optional*; multiplies the grid size of the occurrence rate distribution used to assign planets. Minimum value is 1; maximum value is 10. Default is 1.

usebins: *bool, optional*; if True, ExoVista will assign planets to bins in radius and semi-major axis based on planet types instead of randomly. Default is False.

Returns:

newoccrate: *2-D array (floats)*; an array of planet occurrence rates in M-a- and R-a-space, as appropriate, of the specified grid size.

medge, redge, and **aedge**: *2-D arrays (floats)*; arrays of M-, R-, and a-edge values of the occurrence rate table, respectively. These arrays combine to give the ordered pairs of the coordinates in their respective occurrence rate maps.

mmid, **rmid**, and **amid**: *2-D arrays (floats)*; arrays of M-, R-, and a-midpoint values of the occurrence rate table, respectively. These arrays combine to give the ordered pairs of the coordinates in their respective occurrence rate maps.

generate_planets.add_planets(stars, plorb, expected, orM_array, ora_array, hillsphere_flag, randrad, rng):

Adds planets to the planets array based on the occurrence rates. This function fills out the array up to the expected number of planets randomly, without looking at the other planets in the system. All added planets are flagged to check their stability later.

Parameters:

stars: *DataFrame*; a table of stellar parameters to which to assign the planets.

plorb: *3-D array (floats)*; the table of current planets. New planets will be added to this table starting from the first vacant (all zeros) entry for each star.

expected: *2-D array (ints)*; the 2-D histogram of total planets expected for each gridpoint in R-P space, rounded to the nearest integer.

orM_array and **ora_array**: *arrays (floats)*; bin edge arrays of M-values and a-values of the occurrence rate table, respectively. These two arrays combine to give the ordered pairs of the coordinates in the occurrence rate map. Planets will be assigned to random coordinates between the bin edges of the appropriate "pixel" of the grid.

hillsphere_flag: *2-D array (bools)*; a boolean table indicating where new planets have been added. The function will set the entries corresponding to all added planets to `True` and all existing planets to `False`.

randrad: *bool*; if `True`, random variation is added to the computed planet radii, carried over from the main `Settings` object; default is `False`. *Note: not compatible with* `usebins`.

rng: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_planets()`, which carries the same random seed over to `add_planets()`.

Returns:

plorb: *3-D array (floats)*; the updated table of planet parameters.

hillsphere_flag: *2-D array (bools)*; the updated Hill sphere (new planet) flag table.

`generate_planets.remove_unstable_planets(stars, plorb, hillsphere_flag)`

Checks the stability of all newly added planets in the plorb table and removes those that show orbital instability due to overlap of mutual hill spheres. The function always removes the less massive planet of an unstable pair. When a planet is removed, it also re-checks the next planet inward, in case it is mutually unstable with a larger outer planet.

Parameters:

`stars`: *DataFrame*; a table of stellar parameters to which to assign the planets.

`plorb`: *3-D array (floats)*; the table of current planets. Unstable planets will be removed from this table and the table re-sorted for each star to remove gaps in the list.

`hillsphere_flag`: *2-D array (bools)*; a boolean table indicating where new planets have been added, which must therefore be checked for stability.

Returns:

`plorb`: *3-D array (floats)*; the updated table of planet parameters.

`generate_planets.assign_albedo_file(stars, plorb, rng)`

Assigns an albedo file to each planet in the population generated for the input list of stars. Albedo files are assigned randomly from the subset that apply to a given planet's radius and semi-major axis.

Parameters:

`stars`: *DataFrame*; a table of stellar parameters to which planets have been assigned.

`plorb`: *3-D array (floats)*; the table of planet parameters to be assigned albedo files.

`rng`: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_planets()`, which carries the same random seed over to `assign_albedo_file()`.

Returns:

`plalbedo`: *2-D array (strings)*; table of albedo files assigned to each planet

B.3 Module generate_disks

generate_disks.generate_disks(stars, planets, settings, nexozodis=None, rand_components=False)

Creates a randomized array of debris disks associated with the input star list. Each star is given a list of 3 disk components, corresponding roughly to the warm dust, cold dust, and high-inclination cold dust components of our Solar system. The warm dust component is always assigned, while unassigned slots are set to zeros. The disks are generated randomly, but are constrained by the dynamics imposed by the planets. All disk components in the same system are assigned the same composition.

Parameters:

stars: *DataFrame*; a table of stellar parameters to which planets have been assigned.

planets: *3-D array (floats)*; the table of planet parameters to be assigned albedo files.

settings: `Settings` *object*; contains all of the settable code parameters.

nexozodis: *1-D array (floats)*; the pre-assigned list of dust densities given by the stellar targets file, if present. If None, `nexozodis` is assigned randomly. Default is None.

rand_components: *bool*; if `True`, the number of disk components will be randomly selected for each star within the allowed range. Default is `False`.

Returns:

disks: *3-D array (floats)*; table of disk parameters (nstars x 3 x 15).

compositions: *array (strings)*; list of compositions assigned to disks for each star.

B.4 Module `generate_starspots`

`generate_starspots.generate_starspots(stars, settings)`

Creates a randomized table of starspots with a desired distribution and spot coverage fraction for each star in the target list. This is primarily a wrapper for the functions that handle the actual random distributions. However, the "`big`" distribution is handled by this function directly. "`big`" creates a single large starspot equal to the full starspot coverage.
***Note**: the spot coverage is realized as an optical depth, so the true coverage is exp(-nominal coverage).*
***Note**: additional functionality for faculae is planned, but is only partially implemented.*

Parameters:

`stars`: *DataFrame*; a table of stellar parameters to which planets have been assigned. (The spot parameters are listed in this DataFrame.)

`settings`: `Settings` *object*; contains all of the settable code parameters.

Returns:

`spot_table`: *DataFrame*; a table of starspot sizes, locations, and other properties for each star in the target list.

`warm_up_star(star, spots, rng)`

Generates randomized starspots for a single star in such a way as to "warm up" the star by adding and removing features over time to reach equilibrium as opposed to starting with an arbitrary spot distribution.

Parameters:

`star`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

`spots`: *DataFrame*; empty DataFrame serving as a data structure in which to place the spot properties.

`rng`: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_spots()`, which carries the same random seed over to `warm_up_star()`.

Returns:

`spots`: *DataFrame*; the input DataFrame filled with starspot properties for a single star.

`generate_mature_spots(star, spots, rng)`

This is the workhorse function to create the majority of the starspot pattern. It is called by `warm_up_star()` to create an "initial" distribution of spots with the desired area of coverage.

Parameters:

`star`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

`spots`: *DataFrame*; empty DataFrame serving as a data structure in which to place the spot properties.

`rng`: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_spots()`, which carries the same random seed over to `generate_mature_spots()`.

Returns:

`spots`: *DataFrame*; the input DataFrame filled with starspot properties for a single star.

`birth_spots(dt, star, spots, rng)`

This function is used by the time-evolution part of `warm_up_star()` to add new spots to the distribution as needed to maintain the same area of coverage.

Parameters:

`dt`: *float*; the timestep to evolve the starspot distribution forward, in days.

`star`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

`spots`: *DataFrame*; empty DataFrame serving as a data structure in which to place the spot properties.

`rng`: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_spots()`, which carries the same random seed over to `birth_spots()`.

Returns:

`spots`: *DataFrame*; the input DataFrame filled with starspot properties for a single star.

`generate_new_spots(nspots, star, rng)`

This is the workhorse function called by `birth_spots()` to create new randomized entries in the `spots` DataFrame to be processed by the higher-level functions.

Parameters:

`nspots`: *int;* the number of spots to be added to the DataFrame.

`star`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

`rng`: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_spots()`, which carries the same random seed over to `generate_new_spots()`.

Returns:

`spots`: *DataFrame*; the input DataFrame filled with starspot properties for a single star.

`age_spot(spot, growth_rate, decay_rate, dt)`

This function is used by the time-evolution part of `warm_up_star()` to add new spots to the distribution as needed to maintain the same area of coverage.

Parameters:

`spot`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of properties for a single starspot.

`growth_rate`: *float*; the fractional (exponential) growth rate of the spot in day^{-1}.

`decay_rate`: *float*; the linear decay rate of the spot in MSH/day.

`dt`: *float*; the timestep to evolve the starspot distribution forward, in days.

Returns:

`spot`: *DataFrame*; the input DataFrame with values adjusted for the new timestep.

`get_coordinate(nspots, distribution, rng)`

This function is called by `generate_mature_spots()` and `generate_new_spots()` to assign latitude and longitude coordinates to the spots based on the distribution parameter.

Parameters:

`nspots`: *int*; the number of spots to be placed.

`distribution`: *string*; the choice of distribution for the spots. "`iso`" produces an isotropic random distribution. "`solar`" produces bands of spots in the mid-latitude mimicking the distribution on the sun. "`big`" is handled in `generate_starspots()`.

`rng`: `numpy.random.default_rng` *object*; random number generator created by `generate_spots()`, which carries the same random seed over to `get_coordinates()`.

Returns:

`lat`: *1-D array (floats)*; the latitudes of the starspots.

`lon`: *1-D array (floats)*; the longitudes of the starspots.

B.5 Module make_starmap

Retrieves a single stellar spectrum for a desired effective temperature and surface gravity, interpolated from the Phoenix grid.

`get_single_spectrum(teff, logg)`

Parameters:

`teff`: *float*; the effective temperature of the stellar spectrum in kelvin.

`logg`: *float*; the log-surface gravity of the stellar spectrum in cm s^{-2}.

Returns:

`specf`: *1-D array (floats)*; the stellar spectrum at the surface in cgs units.

`get_quiet_spectrum(star, star_area)`

Computes a two-component stellar spectrum with granulation and no spots as a linear combination of two effective temperatures. The parameters of the granulation are set within the `star` data structure.

Parameters:

`star`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

`star_area`: *float*; the effective area of the stellar disk accounting for limb darkening relative to a flat disk. (This is approximately 0.91 for the built-in limb darkening function.)

Returns:

`specq`: *1-D array (floats)*; the stellar spectrum at the surface in cgs units.

`get_combined_spectrum(star, spots, mask, star_area, lon_center=0, lat_center=0, planet=0, index=0)`

This is the outward-facing stellar spectrum function called by generate_scene for computing astrophysical scenes. It includes both granulation and starspots.

Parameters:

`star`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

`spots`: *DataFrame*; the data structure of starspot properties for a single star.

mask: 2-D array (floats): pixel-by-pixel limb darkening mask of the stellar disk.

star_area: *float*; the effective area of the stellar disk accounting for limb darkening relative to a flat disk. (This is approximately 0.91 for the built-in limb darkening function.)

lon_center and **lat_center**: the longitude and latitude on the stellar surface on which the disk image is centered. Defaults are both `0`.

planet: *int*; the index of the planet that is the vantage point for the image of the stellar disk. Default is `0`, which corresponds to the observer.

index: int; index of the timestep at which the image is calculated. This is determined externally and is used only for image generation inside `make_starmap`. Default is `0`.

Returns:

spec_combined: *1-D array (floats)*; the stellar spectrum at the surface in cgs units.

`ld_single(r, u1=0., u2=0.)`

Computes the point-based limb darkening of a single starspot.

Parameters:

r: *float*; the distance of the spot from the center of the disk as a fraction of the stellar radius.

u1 and **u2**: *floats*; the limb darkening coefficients.

Returns:

mask: *float*; the fractional limb darkening at the spot's location.

`spot_areas(star, spots, star_area, lon_center=0, lat_center=0, planet=0, index=0)`

Computes the projected areas of the starspots, their penumbras, and umbras as seen from the vantage point.

Parameters:

star: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

spots: *DataFrame*; the data structure of starspot properties for a single star.

`star_area`: *float*; the effective area of the stellar disk accounting for limb darkening relative to a flat disk. (This is approximately 0.91 for the built-in limb darkening function.)

`lon_center` and **`lat_center`**: the longitude and latitude on the stellar surface on which the disk image is centered. Defaults are both `0`.

`planet`: *int*; the index of the planet that is the vantage point for the image of the stellar disk. Default is `0`, which corresponds to the observer.

`index`: int; index of the timestep at which the image is calculated. This is determined externally and is used only for image generation inside `make_starmap`. Default is `0`.

Returns:

`[s_proj,p_proj,u_proj]`: *list of 1-D arrays (floats)*; the areas of the starspots, the starspot penumbras, and the starspot umbras, respectively, as fractions of the total stellar disk area.

`star_map_ortho(star, spots, mask, lon_center=0, lat_center, planet=0, index=0, starscale=1)`

Computes an image of the stellar disk as seen by from the specified vantage point.

Parameters:

`star`: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

`spots`: *DataFrame*; the data structure of starspot properties for a single star.

`mask`: 2-D array (floats): pixel-by-pixel limb darkening mask of the stellar disk.

`star_area`: *float*; the effective area of the stellar disk accounting for limb darkening relative to a flat disk. (This is approximately 0.91 for the built-in limb darkening function.)

`lon_center` and **`lat_center`**: the longitude and latitude on the stellar surface on which the disk image is centered. Defaults are both `0`.

`planet`: *int*; the index of the planet that is the vantage point for the image of the stellar disk. Default is `0`, which corresponds to the observer.

`index`: int; index of the timestep at which the image is calculated. This is determined externally and is used only for image generation inside `make_starmap`. Default is `0`.

starscale: sets the size of the stellar image relative to the limb darkening map. Should be set to 1 for normal scene generation. May be set to <1 for coronagraphic modeling. Default is 1.

Returns:

pix/255: *3-D array (floats)*; the RGB values of the image scaled to the 0-1 range.

(Image output directly to file if the "im.save" line is not commented out.)

get_data_cube(star, spots, lon_center=0, lat_center=0, lmid=0.55, bandpass=0.125, bins=10, starscale=1)

Computes a (low-resolution) spectral data cube of the stellar disk as seen from the specified vantage point.

Parameters:

star: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

spots: *DataFrame*; the data structure of starspot properties for a single star.

lon_center and **lat_center**: *floats*; the longitude and latitude on the stellar surface on which the disk image is centered. Defaults are both 0.

Lmid: *float*; the band center at which to compute the spectrum, in microns. Default is 0.55.

bandpass: *float*; the fractional bandwidth of the spectrum. Default is 0.125.

bins: *int*; the number of bins in the spectrum. Default is 10.

starscale: sets the size of the stellar image relative to the limb darkening map. Should be set to 1 for normal scene generation. May be set to <1 for coronagraphic modeling. Default is 1.

Returns:

cube: *3-D array (floats)*; the spectral data cube.

B.6 Module generate_scene

Generates the scene of a planetary system with stellar spectrum, planetary contrast spectra, per-pixel disk contrast spectra, and transit and eclipse times. Both stellar and planetary spectra are computed per-timestep, although the stellar spectrum does not change. This scene is the "real" or "exact" image with no PSF or throughput function applied, although it does require a pixel scale to be specified. It may be used to model detection, characterization, and other observation methods with a simulated pipeline.

generate_scene.load_lqsca(lqq_dir, composition, rdust, rdust_boundaries, lam)

Loads the scattering cross-section table for the specified disk composition. Absorption and scattering cross sections as a function of wavelength are listed for each composition and particle size in the `lqq_dir` directory. The `load_lqsca()` function reads in the files for each particle size for the given composition and builds a 2-D table of scattering cross sections.

Parameters:

`lqq_dir`: *string*; the name of the directory where the cross-section files are found.

`composition`: *string*; the name of the disk composition.

`rdust`: *array (floats)*; the particle sizes used to build the cross-section table. By default, this is based on an array defined in `defaults.py`.

`rdust_boundaries`: *2-D array (floats)*: the upper and lower bounds of each particle size bin (used to construct the filenames of the cross-section files).

`lam`: *array (floats)*; the array of wavelengths used to build the cross-section table.

Returns:

`Qsca_array`: *2-D array (floats)*; table of particle cross scattering sections (nsizes x nlambda).

generate_scene.load_lqabs(lqq_dir, composition, rdust, rdust_boundaries, lam)

Loads the absorption cross-section table for the specified disk composition. Absorption and scattering cross sections as a function of wavelength are listed for each composition and particle size in the `lqq_dir` directory. The `load_lqabs()` function reads in the files for each particle size for the given composition and builds a 2-D table of scattering cross sections.

Parameters:

`lqq_dir`: *string*; the name of the directory where the cross-section files are found.

`composition`: *string*; the name of the disk composition.

`rdust`: *array (floats)*; the particle sizes used to build the cross-section table. By default, this is based on an array defined in `defaults.py`.

`rdust_boundaries`: *2-D array (floats)*: the upper and lower bounds of each particle size bin (used to construct the filenames of the cross-section files).

`lam`: *array (floats)*; the array of wavelengths used to build the cross-section table.

Returns:

`Qabs_array`: *2-D array (floats)*; table of particle absorption cross sections (nsizes x nlambda).

`generate_scene.lambertian(beta)`

Simple function to compute the Lambertian reflectivity for a given angle.

Parameters:

`beta`: *array (floats)*; a list of angles to compute.

Returns:

`phi`: *array (floats)*; the corresponding reflectivity for each angle.

`generate_scene(stars, spots, planets, disks, albedos, compositions, settings)`

The main function for `generate_scene` and the direct output function for ExoVista as a whole. This function takes all of the parameters of planetary systems generated by or read into the code, sets up the relevant arrays and constants, computes the corresponding scene for each star over time, and outputs the results as a FITS file. (This is also the function that loops over the individual stars.)

Parameters:

`stars`: *DataFrame*; the data structure of stellar properties.

`spots`: *DataFrame*; the data structure of starspot properties.

`planets`: *3-D array (floats)*; the array of planet properties for each system.

disks: *3-D array (floats)*; the array of disk properties for each system.

albedos: *2-D array (strings)*: the albedo file assigned to each planet.

compositions: *array (strings)*; the disk composition assigned to each system.

settings: `Settings` *object*; contains all of the settable code parameters.

Returns: None (FITS files are written to disk.)

distribute_diskpoints(s, disk, rdust, drdust, Qsca, xcen=0, ycen=0, xwidth=settings.npix, ywidth=settings.npix)

Computes the disk contrast data cube for a given planetary system. This is an array of per-pixel contrast of the dust disk with the star over a low-resolution spectrum. A low spectral resolution is used to save memory because dust scattering spectra tend not to have narrow features. *Note: this function utilizes the Cython class* `PyImage`.

Parameters:

s: *DataFrame entry*; the data structure of stellar properties for a single star.

disk: *2-D array (floats)*; the array of disk properties for the planetary system.

rdust: *array (floats)*; the particle sizes used to build the cross-section table.

drdust: *array (floats)*; the widths of the `rdust` bins.

Qsca: *2-D array (strings)*: the dust cross section table, normally that returned by `load_lqsca()`.

xcen and **ycen**: *floats*; disk-relative coordinates of the center of the disk image to be calculated, **in AU**. *Note that these coordinates are relative to the star, not to the corner of the frame like the pixel coordinates.* They are rotated so that `xcen` lies along the disk's axis of inclination, and `ycen` lies perpendicular to that axis. Defaults are both `0`.

xwidth and **ywidth**: *floats*; size of disk image to be calculated **in pixels**. This allows a subset of the full frame to be calculated to reduce execution time. (For some applications, such as calibration, only a "postage stamp' of the frame is required.) *Note that these coordinates are aligned with the image frame and not rotated.* Defaults are both `settings.npix`.

Returns:

masterimg: *3-D array (floats)*; the disk contrast spectrum data cube (npix x npix x nlambda_disk).

rgen(numx, numy=0)

Generates an array of radial coordinates associated with an x-y pixel coordinate grid, with the star at (0,0). This is converted to an array of angular separations from the star used by `distribute_diskpoints()` to compute the disk flux at each pixel.

Parameters:

numx: *int*; the size of the pixel array in the x-dimension.

numy: *int*; the size of the pixel array in the x-dimension. Default value is `0`, which is reset to numx.

Returns:

r: *2-D array (floats)*; the grid of radial coordinates of each pixel.

x and **y**: *arrays (floats)*; the lists of x- and y-coordinates used to build the grid.

get_stellar_flux(s, lam, path='./', spectrum=None)

Note: this function is obsolete and has been superseded by the stellar spectrum functions in the `make_starmap` module.
Computes the stellar spectrum for a given star from the Kurucz & Castelli ATLAS9 stellar atmosphere models. *Note that unlike the other spectra, which are contrast values, the stellar spectrum is computed in units of janskys.*

Parameters:

s: *DataFrame entry*; the stellar parameters to compute the spectrum.

lam: *array (float)*; the wavelength points to compute the spectrum.

path: *string*; the location of the Kurucz & Castelli model table. Default value is the current directory.

spectrum: *string*; if defined, sets a stellar spectrum file to be used in place of the built-in models. Default is None.

Returns:

interplambda: *array (floats)*; the output wavelength array on which the spectrum is computed. This is the union of the built-in wavelength array of the table, the requested `lam` array for the ExoVista output, and the `transition_lambda` transition wavelength values.

fstar: *array (floats)*; the stellar flux on the `interplambda` array.

`getkurucz(teff, logg, metallicity=0.0)`

Note: this function is deprecated and is included only for backward-compatibility purposes. Stellar spectra are now handled by the `make_starmap` module.
Interpolates the Kurucz & Castelli spectrum table to the star's effective temperature, surface gravity, and metallicity.

Parameters:

teff: *float*; the effective temperature of the star.

logg: *float*; the log-surface gravity of the star.

metallicity: *float*; the metallicity of the star in dex. Default value is `0.0`. *Note: currently returns an error if not set to zero.*

Returns:

lam: *array (floats)*; the wavelength array of the Kurucz & Castelli table.

Bnu: *array (floats)*; the stellar flux on the `lam` array in units of (erg s^{-1} cm^{-2} Hz^{-1} sr^{-1}).

`read_albedo_file(filename)`

Reads in the albedo file for a given planet. There are three types of albedo file: isotropic, phase-resolved, and latitude-longitude-resolved. These return 1-D, 2-D, and 3-D arrays of albedo values, respectively. This function handles all three formats, and there are corresponding sections of `thread_the_scene()` that convert each one to a planetary spectrum.

Parameters:

filename: *string*; the name of the albedo file.

Returns:

lam: *array (floats)*; the wavelength array of the albedo file.

`phi`: *array (floats)*; the array of phase/longitude values of the albedo file. If the file is not phase-resolved, this is an array of length 1.

`lat`: *array (floats)*; the array of latitude values of the albedo file. If the file is not latitude-resolved, this is an array of length 1.

`gI`: *1-D, 2-D, or 3-D array (floats)*; the array albedo values from the file.

B.7 Module `read_solarsystem`

`read_solarsystem(settings, system_file='example_system.dat')`

Reads in a file containing the parameters for a single planetary system and converts it to the five data structures used by `generate_scene()`. *Note: each output array has one more dimension than the shape of its data structure would suggest. In each case, the outermost dimension has length one and is included for compatibility reasons, as `generate_scene()` expects a list of systems.*

Parameters:

`settings`: `Settings` *object*; contains all of the settable code parameters.

`system_file`: *string*; the file from which to read in the planetary system parameters. Default value is "`example_system.dat`", which contains parameters for our Solar system.

Returns:

`stars`: *DataFrame*; the data structure of stellar properties.

`planet`: *3-D array (floats)*; the array of planet properties.

`albedo_files`: *2-D array (strings)*: the albedo file assigned to each planet. (The outer dimension is a single entry of the entire list for compatibility reasons.)

`disks`: *3-D array (floats)*; the array of disk properties.

`compositions`: *array (strings)*; the disk composition.

`settings`: `Settings` *object*; contains the settable code parameters (which may have been changed by the input file).

B.8 Module nbody

`nbody(cartin, GM, R, istar, curr_time, desired_time)`

Takes one timestep of the N-body integrator. Specifically, it sets up the `state` matrix and calls the integration functions repeatedly to reach the desired precision. It also calls `detect_transits()` to find transit and eclipse times.
Note: this function utilizes the Cython class `PyIntegrator`*.*

Parameters:

`cartin`: *list of arrays (floats)*; the (barycentric) cartesian position and velocity coordinates of the star and planets at the stars of the timestep.

`GM`: *array (floats)*; the GM mass parameter for the star and planets.

`R`: *array (floats)*; the radii for the star and planets.

`istar`: *float*; the inclination of the system midplane.

`curr_time`: *float*; the current time at the start of the timestep.

`desired_time`: *float*; the desired time at the end of the timestep.

Returns:

`cartout`: *list of arrays (floats)*; the cartesian position and velocity coordinates of the star and planets at the end of the timestep.

`tlist`: *list (floats)*; a list of times of transit and eclipse events within the timestep, in years.

`transmaster`: *list of lists (ints)*; a list containing a list of status for each planet over the times in `tlist`: `+1` for transit, `-1` for secondary eclipse, `0` for no event.

`detect_transits(R, istar, state)`

Determines whether any planets are in transit or secondary eclipse at a given integrator step by measuring the coordinate difference between the planets and stars and comparing them with the sum of radii.

Parameters:

`R`: *array (floats)*; the radii for the star and planets.

`istar`: *float*; the inclination of the system midplane.

`state`: *2-D array (floats)*; compilation of star and planet coordinate lists at that integrator step.

Returns:

`mintrans`: float; a parameter used for integration step size control based on the minimum of the distance of a planet from the stellar disk divided by the planet's angular speed.

`translist`: array (floats); an array of the current status of each planet: `+1` for transit, `-1` for secondary eclipse, `0` for no event.

B.9 Module `coordinates`

`cartesian(GM, kepcoords)`

Converts the orbital elements of a list of planetary orbits to cartesian position and velocity vectors relative to the star. *Note that the coordinate transforms are heliocentric (and thus don't include the star in the vector) rather than barycentric like the N-body integrator. This is necessary for generating the image, which always centers the star.*

Parameters:

`GM`: *array (floats)*; the GM mass parameter for the planets.

`kepcoords`: *list of arrays (floats)*; the Keplerian orbital elements for the planets.

Returns:

`[x, y, z, vx, vy, vz]`: *list of arrays (floats)*; the (heliocentric) position and velocity vectors for the planets.

`keplerian(GM, cartcoords)`

Converts cartesian position and velocity vectors relative to the star to instantaneous orbital elements for the planets.

Parameters:

`GM`: *array (floats)*; the GM mass parameter for the planets.

`cartcoords`: *list of arrays (floats)*; the (heliocentric) position and velocity vectors for the planets.

Returns:

`[a, e, I, longnode, argperi, meananom]`: *list of arrays (floats)*; the Keplerian orbital elements for the planets.

B.10 Module `wrapImage` / Class `PyImage` / C++ Class `Image`

Note: this is a Cython class. `PyImage` is the Python class, which is a wrapper for the C++ `Image` class. They are implemented in Python with `wrapImage.pyx` and `wrapImage.pxd`. They are implemented in C++ with `Image.cpp` and `Image.h`. The API below describes the usage in normal Python code.

`wrapImage.PyImage()`

Constructor for the `PyImage` class. It holds the logical structures needed to call the C++ routines.

Parameters: None

Returns: `PyImage` object.

`PyImage.SetupImage(rs, Te, rdb, ts, di, rd, drd, Qs)`

Calls the constructor for the C++ Image object. This object holds the star and disk parameters needed to compute the disk image.

Parameters:

`rs`: *float*; the radius of the star.

`Te`: *float*; the effective temperature of the star.

`rdb`: *float*; the dust blowout grain size in microns. Grains smaller than this are assumed to be removed from the system by radiation pressure. Default value is 0.5, set by `defaults.py`.

`ts`: *float*; the sublimation temperature of the dust in kelvins. Grains interior to the radius where this temperature occurs than this are assumed to be removed from the system by sublimation. Default value is 1500, set by `defaults.py`.

`di`: *2-D array (floats)*; the disk parameters for the system.

`rd`: *array (floats)*; the array of dust sizes in the cross-section table.

`drd`: *array (float)*; the width of the grain size bins in the cross-section table.

`Qs`: *2-D array (floats)*; the optical cross-section table for the disk dust composition.

Returns: None

`PyImage.disk_imager(x, y, z, r, dv, cosscattang)`

Computes the disk brightness at a given pixel of the output image by a radiative transfer algorithm. First, the disk is rotated to be aligned with a cartesian coordinate grid. Then, the line of sight to the observer is subdivided in all three dimensions to account for local density variations in the disk. The radiative transfer calculation is performed over each 2-D subpixel, and reported as a spectrum. The spatial resolution of the radiative transfer calculation is determined by the size of the input arrays, and this resolution is iterated upon by `generate_scene.distribute_diskpoints()` to achieve the desired precision, them summed over the pixel. *Note that this assumes the exozodi disk is optically thin.*

Parameters:

x, **y**, and **z**: *3-D arrays (floats)*; the disk-relative x-, y-, and z- coordinates of each sub-voxel in the pixel addressed by the radiative transfer calculation.

r: *3-D array (floats)*; the distance from the star in AU of each sub-voxel.

dv: *3-D array (floats)*; the volume of each sub-voxel in AU^3.

`cosscatang`: *3-D array (floats)*; the cosine of the scattering angle from the star to the observer for each sub-voxel.

Returns:

`flux`: *3-D array (floats)*; the contrast spectrum of the disk with the star for each 2-D subpixel in the pixel (`nx` x `ny` x `nlambda`).

B.11 Module `wrapIntegrator` / Class `PyIntegrator` / C++ Class `Integrator`

Note: this is a Cython class. `PyIntegrator` is the Python class, which is a wrapper for the C++ `Integrator` class. They are implemented in Python with `wrapIntegrator.pyx` and `wrapIntegrator.pxd`. They are implemented in C++ with `Integrator.cpp` and `Integrator.h`. The API below describes the usage in normal Python code.

`wrapIntegrator.PyIntegrator()`

Constructor for the `PyImage` class. It holds the logical structures needed to call the C++ routines.

Parameters: None

Returns: `PyImage` object.

`PyIntegrator.SetupIntegrator(GMin, stin, tin, dtin)`

Calls the constructor for the C++ Integrator object. This object holds the mass, coordinate, and time states that need to be tracked by the integrator.

Parameters:

`GMin`: *array (floats)*; the GM mass parameter for the star and planets.

`stin`: *2-D array (floats)*; compilation of the `cartin` coordinate list into an array used by the integrator.

`tin`: float; the current time.

`dtin`: float; the integrator timestep (smaller than the output timestep)

`PyIntegrator.integrate()`

The core integration function for the N-body integrator, based on the Bulirsch-Stoer integrator written by Henon & Wisdom.

Parameters: None

Returns: None (The integrator state is returned by utility functions.)

`PyIntegrator.getState()`

Utility function returning the planet and star coordinates in a way that can be read by Python.

Parameters: None

Returns:

`state`: *2-D array (floats)*; compilation of the current star and planet coordinates.

`PyIntegrator.getTime()`

Utility function returning the time in a way that can be read by Python.

Parameters: None

Returns:

`time`: *float*; the current time in the integrator, in years.

`PyIntegrator.getDeltaT()`

Utility function returning the timestep size in a way that can be read by Python.

Parameters: None

Returns:

`official_delta_T`: *float*; the current timestep size of the integrator, in years.

`PyIntegrator.setDeltaT()`

Utility function allowing the timestep size to be set from Python.

Parameters:

`newdeltaT`: *float*; the new timestep size of the integrator, in years.

Returns: None

`equations_of_motion(GM, state)`

Computers the “equations” of motion of the star and planets, i.e. the 3-D velocities and accelerations because on Newton’s law of gravity.

Parameters:

`local_state`: *array (floats)*; the position and velocity vectors for the star and planets.

Returns:

`local_deriv`: *2-D array (floats)*; the derivative of the state vector, i.e. the velocity and acceleration vectors for the star and planets computed by the function.

B.12 Dataclass `Settings.py`

A Dataclass is a Python class that contains only a structure of data. The `Settings` Dataclass contains all of the code parameters that are intended to be user-settable, as well as their default values. A `Settings` Dataclass with the desired values must be passed to the functions that use any of these parameters. The included parameters are listed below.

Imaging and spectroscopy parameters
`pixscale`: the pixel size in arcseconds. Default value is 0.002.
`iwa`: the inner working angle of the coronagraph, in arcseconds. Default value is 0.015.
`iwa_tol`: the fractional tolerance in precision required for the disk image interior to the inner working angle. Default value is 0.1 (compared with 0.05 or less outside the IWA).
`npix`: size of (square) image in pixels. Default value is 250.
`specres`: resolution of the star and planet output spectra. Default is 300.
`specresdisk`: spectral resolution of the disk contrast cube. Default is 10.
`lambdamin` and **`lambdamax`**: minimum and maximum wavelength of spectra in microns, respectively. Defaults are 0.3 and 1.0, respectively.
`hires`: if `True`, resets `specresdisk` to equal `specres`. Default is `False`.
`mapsize`: size of the limb-darkening map for the star in pixels. Default is 1800.

Planet population parameters
`seed`: the (integer) seed of the random number generator. Default is `None`.
`emin` and **`emax`**: minimum and maximum eccentricity, respectively. *Note: eccentricity must be <1.* Defaults are both 0.0.
`imin` and **`imax`**: minimum and maximum orbital inclination relative to the system midplane, respectively, in degrees. Zero inclination may produce unstable behavior in the orbit orientation. Defaults are 0.0 and 5.0, respectively.
`sysimin` and **`sysimax`**: minimum and maximum system inclination relative to the plane of the sky, respectively, in degrees. (I.e. zero is face-on, 90 is edge-on.) Defaults are 0.0 and 180.0.
`sysPAmin` and **`sysPAmax`**: minimum and maximum position angle of the system midplane (rotation relative to the sensor), respectively, in degrees. Defaults are 0.0 and 360.0.
`eecprob`: the probability that a planet in the EEC bounding box will be an EEC. Default is 1.0.
`randphase`: if `True`, adds random variation to the Lambertian phase functions. Default is `False`.
`randrad`: if `True`, adds random variation to the mass-radius relation. Default is `False`.

Disk model parameters
`ncomponents`: number of disk components per star. Default value is 2, but is reset base on the size of the disk array (including zeros).
`diskoff`: if `True`, the disk contrast cube will not be calculated by `generate_scene()` and will be set to zero instead. This is useful to speed up testing. Default value is `False`.
`minsize` and **`maxsize`**: the minimum and maximum sizes of dust grains considered, respectively, in microns. Default values are 0.1 and 1000.0, respectively.

rdust_blowout: the minimum dust grain size in microns based on blowout by radiation pressure. Default value is 0.5.
tsublimate: the sublimation temperature of dust grains in kelvins. Default value is 1500.

Disk profile parameters
density_ratio: the maximum ratio between the densities of disk components. Default value is 5.
stability_factor: the minimum separation between a planet and a dust belt, in Hill radii. Default value is 3.
rinner_mass_threshold: the minimum mass of planet needed to truncate the disk to its interior, in Earth masses. Default value is 100.
dror_min and **dror_max**: the minimum and maximum fractional widths of dust belts, respectively. Default values are 0.05 and 0.3.
hor_min and **hor_max**: the minimum and maximum fractional scale height of the disk, respectively. Default values are 0.03 and 0.2.
r_min and **r_max**: lists of the minimum and maximum circumstellar distances, respectively of the three disk components, in AU. Defaults values are [0.5,5.,50.] and [5.,50.,500.].

Scene parameters
timemax: the end time used by the N-body integrator in years. Default value is 1.e-10 (single image only). Typical values for a survey are 5-10.
dt: timestep for the nbody integrator in (Julian) years. Default value is 10/365.25 (10 days).
output_dir: output directory. Default value is "output".
overwrite: if `True`, existing FITS files with the same ID number as a target star will be automatically overwritten. Default is `False`.
starspots: if `True`, the stellar spectra will be computed with starspots. Default is `True`.

Two parameters are computed by the `__post_init__()` function that runs automatically upon initialization:

pixscale_mas: the pixel size in milliarcseconds, based on pixscale.
specrdisk is also reset by `hires` in this function, if applicable.

B.13 Module `constants.py`

This module does not contain any functions, but does contain a list of constant values that are needed by various functions in the code. These constants are listed below.

Physical constants
`grav_const`: the gravitational constant in units of AU^3 yr^{-2} $Msun^{-1}$.
`c`: the speed of light in AU yr^{-1}.
`planck`: Planck's constant in cgs units.
`R_sun`: the radius of the Sun.
`MSH`: the unit area of starspots, the micro-solar hemisphere

Data structure parameters
`maxnplanets`: number of planets per star. Default is `30`, but is reset based on the size of the planets array (including zeros).
`mincomponents`: minimum number of disk components. Default is `1`.
`maxcomponents`: maximum number of disk components. Default is `3`.

File paths
`exovistapath`: path to the main ExoVista directory, where the relevant data values should be. Default value is the current directory.
`lqq_dir`: directory where the dust cross-section tables are stored. Default value is "lqq_files/".

Dust model parameters. These are used to define the dust cross-section filenames procedurally from a minimum and maximum grain size, and a resolution in log-grain size. However, this method consistently failed to produce the correct filenames due to rounding errors, and the commented-out variables are not used.

The arrays **`master_rdust`** and **`master_rdust_boundaries`** are hard-coded with the specific decimals used in the cross-section filenames. These should not be changed unless the cross-section tables do, or else the code will crash.
`master_nsizes`: the length of the `master_rdust_boundaries` array.
`master_drdust`: widths of the grain size bins, generated automatically from the `master_rdust_boundaries` array.

Table headings. These describe the valid column names for star, planet, and disk properties. In many cases, they are used for indexing, and they are used outside of `generate_scene` where the `**kwargs` reassignment does not apply, so they should not be changed, or else the code will crash or exhibit unstable behavior.

`starbase`: dictionary of included parameter names and default values for stellar properties (excluding `nzodis`, since `nzodis` may need to be randomized).
`alias`: dictionary of valid column header names for the stellar parameters, this allows common substitutions to be used, like "Mstar" vs. "Mass" or "SpT" vs. "Type."

`intlist`: stellar properties that have int rather than float data type.
`strlist`: stellar properties that have string rather than float data type.
`keplist`: list of orbital elements of stars and planets.
`pllabel`: list of planet properties.
`dlabel`: list of disk properties.

FITS file comments. These will not need to change unless you substantially change the format of the output files.
`scomments`: comments in the heading of the stellar data extension (Extension 4).
`pcomments`: comments in the headings of the planetary data extensions (Extension 5+).
`dcomments`: comments in the headings of the disk data extension (Extension 2).

B.14 Class `Scene.py`

Object that reads in a FITS file produced by ExoVista and parses the data into a format that can be easily output by utility functions.
***Note**: all functions in this module exclude the "extra" reference Earth twin, if present.*

Constructor:

`Scene.Scene(inputfile)`

Parameters:

`inputfile`: *string*; FITS file to be read.

`Scene.getStarLambda()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`lambdas`: *array (floats)*; the wavelength points at which the star and planet spectra are calculated, in microns.

`Scene.getDiskLambda()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`lambdas_disk`: *array (floats)*; the wavelength points at which the disk spectral cube is calculated, in microns.

`Scene.getAngDiam()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`angdiam`: *floats*; the angular diameter of the star, in milli-arcseconds.

`Scene.getPixScale()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`pixscale`: *floats*; the pixel scale of the image, in milli-arcseconds.

`Scene.getXYstar(time=0)`

This method returns the star's sky-plane coordinates in the image. However, because the image is centered on the star, they are constant in time.

Parameters:

`time`: *float* OR *array*; time at which the system parameters should be interpolated and output, in years. Default value is `0`.

Returns:

`xystar`: *2-D array (floats)*; array containing 2 subarrays of the *x* and *y* sky-coordinates of the star over time, in pixels.

`Scene.getXYbary(time=0)`

Parameters:

`time`: *float* OR *array*; time at which the system parameters should be interpolated and output, in years. Default value is `0`.

Returns:

`xystar`: *2-D array (floats)*; array containing 2 subarrays of the *x* and *y* barycentric coordinates of the star over time, in AU.

`Scene.getRV(time=0)`

Parameters:

`time`: *float* OR *array*; time at which the system parameters should be interpolated and output, in years. Default value is `0`.

Returns:

`rv`: *array (floats)*; array containing the star's radial velocity over time, in cm/s.

`Scene.getStarSpec(time=0)`

Parameters:

`time`: *float* ONLY; time at which the system parameters should be interpolated and output, in years. Default value is `0`.

Returns:

`fstar`: *array (floats)*; the spectrum of the star, in Janskys.

`Scene.getXYplanets(time=0)`

Parameters:

`time`: *float* ONLY; time at which the system parameters should be interpolated and output, in years. Default value is `0`.

Returns:

`xyplanet`: *2-D array (floats)*; the coordinates of the planets, in pixels.

`Scene.getPlanetSpec(time=0)`

Parameters:

`time`: *float* ONLY; time at which the system parameters should be interpolated and output, in years. Default value is `0`.

Returns:

`fplanet`: *2-D array (floats)*; the spectra of the planets, in Janskys.

`Scene.getOrbits()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`orbits`: *2-D array (floats)*; the orbital elements of the planets: `a`, `e`, `i`, `longnode`, `argperi`, and `meananom`, in AU or decimal degrees, as applicable.

`Scene.countPlanets()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`nplanets`: *int*; the number of planets in the system.

`Scene.countPlanetTypes()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`nplanets`: *2-D array (ints)*; the number of planets in each radius-instellation bin as defined by `planetbins.dat`.

`Scene.countEECs()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`eecs`: *int*; the number of exo-Earth candidates in the system, excluding the "extra" reference Earth twin, if present.

`Scene.getTransits()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`transits`: *list of lists (floats, ints, ints, ints)*; a list of transit and eclipse events over the integration time, including the start/end time if an event is in progress. States are `+1` for in transit, `-1` for in eclipse, and `0` for not in transit or eclipse. Returns all zeros if no events occur.
Sublist 1: time in days.
Sublist 2: ID of planet.
Sublist 3: State before event.
Sublist 4: State after event.

`Scene.getTransitingPlanets()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

None if no planets transit (within the integration time).

`plist`: *array* (*ints)*; the ID numbers for all transiting planets, excluding the "extra" reference Earth twin, if present.

`Scene.getTransitTimes(planet)`

Parameters:

`planet`: *int*; the ID number of the planet to retrieve transits and eclipses.

Returns:

`None, None` if the planet does not transit (within the integration time).

`transits`: *list of lists (floats, floats)*; the timestamps of all transits of the planet within the integration time. Each sublist contains the start and end time of the transit, or the start or end time of the integration if a transit is in progress.

`eclipses`: *list of lists (floats, floats)*; the timestamps of all eclipses of the planet within the integration time. Each sublist contains the start and end time of the eclipse, or the start or end time of the integration if an eclipse is in progress.

`Scene.getDiskImage()`

Parameters: None

Returns:

`diskimage`: *3-D array (floats)*; the disk constrast data cube of brightness relative to the star, except interpolated to the same wavelengths as the stellar spectrum.

B.15 Module `add_background.py`

`add_background.add_background(inputfile, time=0)`

Reads in a FITS file produced by ExoVista and generates a data cube of extragalactic background sources based on the Haystacks model of Roberg et al. (2017).

***Note**: this module requires Extragalactic background cubes 0 through 5 from https://asd.gsfc.nasa.gov/projects/haystacks/downloads.html*

Parameters:

`inputfile`: *string*; FITS file to be read.

`time`: *float*; time at which the system parameters should be interpolated and output, in years. Default value is `0`.

Returns:

`background_final`: *3-D array (floats)*; data cube of extragalactic background fluxes in janskys per pixel, with the same format as the disk data cube.